

DISCOVERY / PRIORITIES / EVIDENCE / RELEASES

Software Product Management English

Clarify the problem. Make the trade-off explicit.

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Eight lessons. Eleven extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases
220 extended-dialogue turns / 11 transfer exchanges
Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For product managers, product owners, product analysts, and cross-functional software teams.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight product conversations moving from user problems and priorities to measurable acceptance, experiments, releases, and decisions.

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A product conversation should move a decision.

A feature request is not yet a user problem, a roadmap is not unlimited capacity, and a favorable metric is not the whole outcome. Product managers need language that connects user evidence, business commitments, technical constraints, and a clear next decision. These cases practice that work through concrete requests, numerical examples, disagreements, and handoffs.

Ask what the user was trying to do

A requested button names one possible solution. Identify the task, the obstacle, and the evidence before deciding what to build. Similar support tickets may describe different problems.

"Eight tickets concern finding the action; four concern permission to use it."

Say what gives way

Prioritization has a consequence when capacity is limited. Explain which criterion is being applied and which work is deferred. Calling every request urgent does not create another delivery slot.

"We can fit the committed audit work and setup recovery; the refresh moves out."

Attach a definition to the metric

A conversion rate needs a denominator and time window. A load-time requirement needs a start, an endpoint, and test conditions. Keep those definitions near the numbers.

"Setup completion is measured within seven days of signup for each mature cohort."

Finish with the decision and next check

A useful discussion ends with an owner, a boundary, and evidence that would change the position. Separate a recommendation from approval and a progress update from a delivery promise.

"The launch decision remains open until Support confirms the required migration notes."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

Original fictional English practice, not a product-management certification, statistical analysis service, software security assessment, or release authorization. All teams, data, dates, and decisions are invented. Actual work must follow the organization's responsibilities, research safeguards, engineering controls, experiment methods, and applicable requirements.

One button request, two different problems

A Read the situation

Reframe a requested interface addition using supplied support evidence and agree a focused discovery task.

Support lead Morgan asks product manager Li for a new Export button on the home page. Their review finds 12 relevant tickets from the past month: eight users could not find the existing action, while four found it but lacked the required permission. The records do not show how common either problem is among all users. No design change is approved. Morgan and Li agree to separate the two issues and prepare a two-day investigation of navigation and permission messaging before choosing a solution.

PEOPLE / Morgan: Support lead | Li: Product manager

CLARIFICATION IS NOT REJECTION

A stakeholder may offer a solution because it makes a recurring problem tangible. Acknowledge the problem, then separate the proposed implementation from the evidence. Agree a small next step so the conversation does not feel like an indefinite research delay.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What do eight tickets describe?

- A A completed test of the new button
- C A confirmed outage of every export

- B Difficulty finding the existing Export action
- D Users finding the action but lacking permission

2. What do the other four describe?

- A The action was found, but the required permission was missing.
- C Every user completed the export successfully.

- B The action did not exist anywhere.
- D A home-page redesign was approved.

3. What have Morgan and Li agreed to do?

- A Claim that every user has the same problem.
- C Build the new home-page button immediately.

- B Prepare a two-day investigation of navigation and permission messaging.
- D Remove all export permissions.

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

product discovery

Work to understand problems and test potential product directions.

IN USE conduct product discovery

problem statement

A concise description of a user problem and its context.

IN USE frame the problem statement

solution request

A request for a particular implementation or feature.

IN USE unpack the solution request

user need

An outcome a user needs to accomplish.

IN USE identify the user need

job to be done

The progress or task a user seeks in a given situation.

IN USE clarify the job to be done

user segment

A group of users sharing relevant characteristics or needs.

IN USE define the user segment

support evidence

Information from support interactions used to investigate problems.

IN USE review support evidence

discoverability

How readily users can find an available function.

IN USE improve discoverability

permission

Authorization to perform a defined action.

IN USE explain the permission requirement

access barrier

A condition preventing a user from reaching or using a capability.

IN USE identify the access barrier

navigation path

The sequence of locations used to reach a function.

IN USE trace the navigation path

friction point

A step that makes a user task harder or less reliable.

IN USE locate a friction point

Precision check

Twelve tickets are support evidence, not a census of all users. Eight describe finding the action, and four describe permission. A new button might help the first group but would not itself give the second group authorization to export.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

usability test

Observation of representative users attempting defined tasks.

IN USE run a usability test

task success

Completion of a defined user task under stated conditions.

IN USE measure task success

research question

A specific uncertainty the investigation aims to resolve.

IN USE define the research question

assumption

An unverified premise guiding a proposal or decision.

IN USE test the assumption

hypothesis

A proposed explanation or prediction to evaluate.

IN USE state the hypothesis

prototype

A representation used to explore or test a design.

IN USE compare prototypes

desirability

Whether a solution addresses something users value.

IN USE assess desirability

feasibility

Whether a solution can be built and operated under constraints.

IN USE assess feasibility

viability

Whether a solution can support the relevant business needs.

IN USE assess viability

opportunity

A problem or possibility that could create product value.

IN USE evaluate the opportunity

discovery scope

The defined boundaries of the investigation.

IN USE bound the discovery scope

evidence gap

Missing information needed to support a conclusion.

IN USE identify the evidence gap

Precision check

The two-day scope creates a decision point without predetermining a design. The investigation can examine navigation and permission messaging separately. Its purpose is not to remove legitimate access controls or claim that the requested button is already proven necessary.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE PROBLEM

"We should address the export friction in these tickets."

IDENTIFY THE TASK

"What were users trying to export, and from where?"

NAME THE FIRST ISSUE

"The existing action may have a discoverability problem."

AVOID A FALSE FIX

"Adding a button would not grant authorization."

SEPARATE REQUEST FROM NEED

"The button is one proposed solution, not the problem itself."

SPLIT THE EVIDENCE

"Eight tickets concern finding the action; four concern permission."

NAME THE SECOND ISSUE

"The permission message may need a separate review."

LIMIT THE INFERENCE

"These tickets do not establish prevalence across all users."

Request

May contain a solution before the underlying need is clear.

Users

Specify which users and what evidence supports the claim.

Cannot

Distinguish cannot find from is not permitted to use.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASK A FOCUSED QUESTION

"Can users find the action during the relevant task?"

BOUND THE INVESTIGATION

"Let us spend two days examining these two paths."

COMPARE POSSIBILITIES

"A clearer label and a new location are different options."

AGREE THE HANDOFF

"Bring the observed paths and findings to the next review."

KEEP SAFEGUARDS

"We are not proposing to bypass access controls."

REQUEST USEFUL DETAIL

"Link each ticket to the task and navigation path."

PRESERVE DECISION STATUS

"No design change is approved yet."

CLOSE WITH PURPOSE

"Choose the solution after separating the two problems."

Discoverable

A function existing does not mean people can locate it.

Research

Give it a question, scope, and decision point.

Validate

State what evidence would support or challenge the assumption.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which problem framing fits the tickets?

- A** The product has no export capability.
- B** All users require an extra home-page button.
- C** Permission should be removed because navigation is unclear.
- D** Users encounter two barriers: finding Export and understanding or obtaining the required permission.

2. Which statement overclaims the ticket evidence?

- A** Eight tickets concern finding the existing action.
- B** Four describe a permission restriction after finding it.
- C** Every user is unable to export.
- D** Twelve relevant tickets were reviewed.

3. Which discovery task is appropriately focused?

- A** Redesign every product screen without a defined question.
- B** Approve the requested button before examining either issue.
- C** Ask Support to stop recording permission concerns.
- D** Observe the export path and review permission messaging for the two ticket groups.

4. Why is adding a button not a complete answer for the four permission cases?

- A** Finding an action and being authorized to use it are separate conditions.
- B** A visible button always removes authorization requirements.
- C** Permission has no relationship to export use.
- D** The four users never found the action.

[Answers and explanations: page 85.](#)

One button request, two different problems

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

navigation path / research question / discoverability / problem statement / support evidence / user need / permission / prototype / solution request / discovery scope

- 01 **Morgan:** Can we put an Export button on the home page? Support keeps hearing that people cannot export, and I would like something visible we can point them to.
- 02 **Li:** I want to address that, but let us separate the ¹ _____ from the problem. The existing action already exports, so what happened when these users tried to reach it?
- 03 **Morgan:** We reviewed twelve tickets from last month. Eight users could not find the action. Four found it but did not have the required permission.
- 04 **Li:** Then ² _____ is one issue, not the entire set. We should keep the four permission cases separate instead of treating cannot export as a single diagnosis.
- 05 **Morgan:** So the button might help eight of them, but it would leave the other four stuck. Can we keep those groups separate in the ticket summary?
- 06 **Li:** Right. Their ³ _____ problem needs its own review. We can examine the explanation and request path without suggesting that legitimate access controls should disappear.
- 07 **Morgan:** I can attach the relevant ticket excerpts and task details. We should not just count the phrase cannot export when it can describe different experiences.
- 08 **Li:** That makes the ⁴ _____ more useful. It still does not tell us how common either problem is across all users, so keep that broader claim out of the summary.
- 09 **Morgan:** For the navigation cases, I would like to know where people started and which menu labels they tried. That could explain why the existing location was missed.
- 10 **Li:** Trace the ⁵ _____ during the actual task. A clearer label, a different location, and an additional button are distinct options rather than interchangeable fixes.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Morgan:** How much investigation are we talking about? Support needs a date for an update, even if we cannot promise a fix yet.
- 12 **Li:** Let us set a two-day ⁶ _____. We will examine these two paths and bring the findings back before choosing a design change.
- 13 **Morgan:** For the navigation work, the question should be whether people can find the action when they need it, not whether they like our preferred button idea.
- 14 **Li:** That is a better ⁷ _____. We can observe what happens and compare the evidence with the assumption behind the request.
- 15 **Morgan:** The permission review should also check whether the message explains why access is unavailable and what the legitimate next step is. It should not promise access automatically.
- 16 **Li:** Agreed. Keep the ⁸ _____ separate from a specific control. The product should help users understand the path without disguising an authorization decision as a navigation change.
- 17 **Morgan:** Once we have the observations, we can decide whether to test a revised label, a new location, or another design. We do not have to build every option.
- 18 **Li:** A ⁹ _____ may help compare the relevant direction before implementation. The choice should follow what we learn, not merely the most visible suggestion in the initial request.
- 19 **Morgan:** I will prepare the ticket groups and coordinate the review. Our status will say that we have agreed the investigation, not approved a new home-page feature.
- 20 **Li:** Good. Record the ¹⁰ _____ with both barriers and the remaining uncertainty. That gives Support a clear next step and gives the product team a useful basis for choosing a solution.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. solution request | 2. discoverability | 3. permission | 4. support evidence | 5. navigation path | 6. discovery scope | 7. research question | 8. user need | 9. prototype | 10. problem statement

A visible action can still be restricted

F Say it

Ten tickets are reviewed. Six users could not find Download. Four found it but lacked permission. No design change is approved, and the records do not represent all users.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

users / permission / discoverability / approved

Support: "Six tickets concern ¹ _____."

Product: "Four concern ² _____."

Support: "A design change is not yet ³ _____."

Product: "These records are a ticket sample, not all ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 86

1. discoverability | 2. permission | 3. approved | 4. users

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10 in pairs. Stress finding and permission as different barriers.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Pause after the two-day limit and the no-approval statement.
3. Check the Download exchange, then read it with six and four clearly distinguished.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Three urgent requests, two delivery slots

A Read the situation

Apply agreed priorities to a capacity conflict, explain the displaced work, and distinguish a review date from a delivery promise.

Product owner Nora and commercial sponsor Samir review three features. A improves setup recovery and directly supports the agreed activation goal. B provides audit export needed for a recorded October 31 customer commitment. C refreshes the home page; no fixed commitment or activation evidence is supplied for it. Each feature needs one of two available delivery slots, and splitting them is not feasible this cycle. The agreed rule is to protect fixed commitments first, then the activation goal. Nora proposes B and A, with C reviewed again in two weeks.

PEOPLE / Nora: Product owner | Samir: Commercial sponsor

MAKE THE DEFERRED WORK VISIBLE

A clear no for this cycle can be more useful than an impossible yes. Explain the shared criterion, the capacity constraint, and the work that would be displaced by a change. Give the deferred request an honest review point without quietly promising the next release.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which feature addresses the recorded fixed commitment?

- A C, home-page refresh
- C B, audit export

- B All three have the same recorded commitment
- D A, setup recovery

2. Which pair follows the agreed priority rule?

- A All three within two slots
- C A and C

- B B and A
- D B and C

3. What does the two-week date mean for C?

- A Guaranteed production release
- C Permission to use a third slot

- B Evidence that C already supports activation
- D A review point, not a promised delivery date

Answers and explanations: page 87.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

product roadmap

A communication of intended product direction and priorities over time.

IN USE update the product roadmap

product goal

The future product outcome guiding a defined body of work.

IN USE align with the product goal

prioritization criterion

A stated basis for ordering competing work.

IN USE apply prioritization criteria

capacity constraint

A limit on work the team can undertake in the period.

IN USE state the capacity constraint

delivery slot

A defined allocation of capacity for planned work.

IN USE allocate a delivery slot

fixed commitment

A recorded obligation treated as non-discretionary in the stated planning rule.

IN USE protect a fixed commitment

time-critical work

Work whose value or obligation depends on a specific timing need.

IN USE identify time-critical work

opportunity cost

The value of the best displaced alternative.

IN USE explain opportunity cost

trade-off

A choice that gains one benefit while giving up another.

IN USE make the trade-off explicit

sequencing

Ordering work to respect priorities and dependencies.

IN USE agree the sequencing

dependency

An input or condition required for another item to proceed.

IN USE identify a dependency

deferred item

Work deliberately moved outside the current period.

IN USE record a deferred item

Precision check

With two slots and three one-slot features, selecting C displaces A or B. Under the supplied rule, B comes first because of the recorded commitment, followed by A because it supports activation. No evidence permits treating all three as simultaneously feasible.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

backlog ordering

Arranging planned work by current priority.

IN USE revise backlog ordering

sponsor

A stakeholder advocating or accountable for a proposed investment.

IN USE brief the sponsor

escalation

Raising a decision beyond the current authority or agreement.

IN USE define the escalation route

decision rule

An agreed method for selecting among alternatives.

IN USE use the decision rule

decision log

A record of choices, rationale, and relevant context.

IN USE maintain the decision log

scope split

Dividing work into independently useful smaller parts.

IN USE assess a scope split

confidence level

Stated certainty in an estimate or claim under its defined basis.

IN USE qualify the confidence level

effort estimate

An assessment of the work needed to deliver an item.

IN USE review the effort estimate

cost of delay

The consequence of postponing work over a stated period.

IN USE assess cost of delay

review trigger

A condition prompting reconsideration of a decision.

IN USE define the review trigger

planning horizon

The period covered by a planning discussion.

IN USE state the planning horizon

forecast

A current estimate of a future result, not necessarily a commitment.

IN USE distinguish forecast from commitment

Precision check

A review in two weeks is not a promise to deliver C in two weeks or in the next cycle. New evidence can reopen the priority decision, but it must be evaluated against the same capacity and commitments unless those constraints are explicitly changed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE CAPACITY

"We have two slots for three one-slot features."

PROTECT THE COMMITMENT

"B addresses the recorded October 31 commitment."

QUALIFY THE THIRD REQUEST

"C has no supplied fixed commitment or activation evidence."

NAME THE CONSEQUENCE

"C moves outside this cycle."

NAME THE SHARED RULE

"Fixed commitments come first, then the activation goal."

CONNECT THE OUTCOME

"A directly supports setup recovery and activation."

MAKE THE SELECTION

"On this basis, I recommend B and A."

ASK WHAT GIVES WAY

"Which selected item would C displace?"

Urgent

Ask for the actual timing consequence or obligation.

Priority

Meaningful only when it changes the order or allocation.

Next

Avoid implying the deferred item is automatically next to ship.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK SPLITTING HONESTLY

"The team has assessed splitting as infeasible this cycle."

INVITE RELEVANT EVIDENCE

"What new fact would change C's priority under our rule?"

DEFINE RECONSIDERATION

"We will review C again in two weeks."

RECORD THE BASIS

"Put the selected pair and displaced work in the decision log."

AVOID FALSE CAPACITY

"Calling all three urgent does not create another slot."

SEPARATE APPEAL FROM DECISION

"I can record your objection without pretending the priority changed."

AVOID A HIDDEN PROMISE

"That review date is not a release commitment."

CLOSE CONSISTENTLY

"Communicate the same scope and timing status to every sponsor."

Capacity

A constraint to verify, not a number changed by enthusiasm.

Review

A decision checkpoint, not necessarily approval or delivery.

Committed

Distinguish a recorded obligation from an internal preference.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response best explains deferring C?

- A** C will definitely ship at the two-week review.
- B** B protects the fixed commitment and A supports activation; C does not fit the two-slot capacity.
- C** C is unimportant because its sponsor disagrees.
- D** C is secretly included without additional capacity.

2. If C is added with no capacity change, what must happen?

- A** The October 31 commitment is automatically withdrawn.
- B** A or B must be displaced.
- C** All three still occupy only two slots.
- D** Splitting becomes feasible because the sponsor requests it.

3. What new information could justify reconsideration?

- A** Relevant evidence changing C's position under the agreed criteria
- B** The same urgent label repeated more loudly
- C** A review date mislabeled as a delivery promise
- D** An assumption that effort estimates no longer matter

4. Which statement about the review is accurate?

- A** The review cancels the current pair automatically.
- B** The review proves C has no possible future value.
- C** C will be reconsidered in two weeks without a promised delivery date.
- D** C is guaranteed in production within two weeks.

Answers and explanations: page 87.

Three urgent requests, two delivery slots

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

decision log / opportunity cost / review trigger / product goal / capacity constraint / product roadmap / fixed commitment / decision rule / scope split / deferred item

- 01 **Samir:** All three sponsors are calling their feature urgent. My team wants the home-page refresh included because we have already discussed it in several customer conversations.
- 02 **Nora:** We have a ¹ _____. There are two slots, and the team has assessed each feature at one slot. We need to choose rather than announce a scope the team cannot deliver.
- 03 **Samir:** Understood. But I need more than "there is no room" for the sponsor. Can you walk me through the rule we agreed?
- 04 **Nora:** The agreed ² _____ is fixed commitments first, then the activation goal. It gives us a shared basis instead of comparing the intensity of each sponsor's request.
- 05 **Samir:** The audit export has the October thirty-first customer commitment. That is different from my team's interest in showing a more current home page.
- 06 **Nora:** Yes. B protects that ³ _____. We should not displace it without explicitly addressing the obligation and the required authority, rather than treating it as another optional preference.
- 07 **Samir:** That leaves one slot. Setup recovery directly supports activation, which is the outcome we agreed to improve this cycle. We have not supplied similar evidence for the refresh.
- 08 **Nora:** A therefore aligns with the ⁴ _____. My recommendation is B and A, with C outside this cycle. That is a relative priority decision, not a claim that C can never matter.
- 09 **Samir:** Could we include a smaller refresh alongside the other two? I want to test that option before telling the sponsor the request has moved out.
- 10 **Nora:** We asked about a ⁵ _____, and the team says it is not feasible this cycle. We cannot count on a smaller item without a supported estimate and usable scope.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Samir:** Then putting C back in would require removing one of the selected features. The trade-off should be stated plainly instead of hidden in an overloaded roadmap.
- 12 **Nora:** Exactly. Explain the ⁶ _____. Choosing the refresh means giving up the selected work that would otherwise occupy that slot under our current capacity.
- 13 **Samir:** I can explain that to the sponsor. How can we bring new evidence back if a specific customer consequence becomes clearer?
- 14 **Nora:** Set a ⁷ _____. Relevant new evidence can change the decision, but the review must still account for the fixed commitment, activation goal, and available capacity.
- 15 **Samir:** Two weeks is a review, then, not a release date? I need to correct that in my customer-call notes before it becomes an expectation.
- 16 **Nora:** Correct. C is a ⁸ _____, and the two-week meeting is a review point. It is not automatic approval for the next cycle or a hidden delivery commitment.
- 17 **Samir:** Please record the rationale for every sponsor. Different informal explanations could make a consistent decision look arbitrary.
- 18 **Nora:** I will update the ⁹ _____ with B and A, the capacity limit, and the review point for C. Your concern and the relevant evidence request will be recorded too.
- 19 **Samir:** Then I will tell the commercial team that the refresh is deferred under the agreed rule, not canceled forever, and that the next discussion needs evidence rather than another urgency label.
- 20 **Nora:** That keeps the ¹⁰ _____ honest. We can pursue the current goal while leaving a clear route to reconsider the deferred request when the facts change.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. capacity constraint | 2. decision rule | 3. fixed commitment | 4. product goal | 5. scope split | 6. opportunity cost | 7. review trigger | 8. deferred item | 9. decision log | 10. product roadmap

Two slots still mean two choices

F Say it

There are two slots. X protects a fixed commitment; Y supports the agreed activation goal; Z has neither supplied basis. Each needs one slot, and splitting is infeasible. The rule prioritizes commitments, then activation.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Y / trade-off / X / Z

Product: "The first selection is ¹ _____."

Sponsor: "The second selection is ² _____."

Product: "The deferred item is ³ _____."

Sponsor: "Adding it requires a ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 88

1. X | 2. Y | 3. Z | 4. trade-off

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10. Emphasize two slots and the fixed-commitment rule.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Contrast a review point with a delivery promise.
3. Check the X/Y/Z exchange. Read the selected pair and deferred item aloud in order.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Quickly needs a clock and a test condition

A Read the situation

Turn a vague performance request into a checkable criterion and distinguish that criterion from the wider completion standard.

Product manager Eva and test lead Omar refine a story saying an authorized editor should open the records page quickly. They agree a fictional acceptance test: 100 navigations with the fixed 1,000-record dataset and test profile N, timed from the navigation click until records and the primary action are usable. At least 95 runs must finish within 2 seconds, and every run within 5 seconds without an error. A trial records 96 within 2 seconds and four more within 4.5 seconds, with no errors. Other completion checks remain open.

PEOPLE / Eva: Product manager | Omar: Test lead

DEFINE COMPLETION TOGETHER

A product manager can specify the user outcome without prescribing every engineering detail. A test lead can make it measurable without replacing that outcome with a convenient technical proxy. Agree the user state, timing boundaries, test basis, and pass rule in language both can defend.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. When does the stated timing end?

- A When the first network request is sent
- C When the tester closes the browser

- B When a blank loading shell appears
- D When records and the primary action are usable

2. Does the trial meet the stated timing and error criterion?

- A No; all 100 had to finish within 2 seconds.
- C No; the dataset had to contain 100 records.

- B Yes; a blank page appeared quickly.
- D Yes; 96 finish within 2 seconds and all finish within 5 seconds without errors.

3. What remains open after this trial?

- A The trial's no-error observation
- C The supplied count of 100 navigations

- B Other completion checks
- D The stated dataset size of 1,000 records

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

user story

A short description of user, capability, and intended benefit.

IN USE refine the user story

acceptance criterion

A checkable condition for accepting a specific item.

IN USE define acceptance criteria

Definition of Done

The agreed quality standard for a completed increment in Scrum.

IN USE meet the Definition of Done

functional requirement

A required behavior or capability.

IN USE specify a functional requirement

nonfunctional requirement

A required quality or constraint, such as performance.

IN USE clarify a nonfunctional requirement

precondition

A state that must exist before the test or action.

IN USE state the precondition

postcondition

A state expected after the action completes.

IN USE verify the postcondition

test fixture

Controlled data and setup used for a repeatable test.

IN USE prepare the test fixture

test profile

The defined environment and conditions for a test.

IN USE use the agreed test profile

navigation event

The action that initiates movement to a page or view.

IN USE timestamp the navigation event

usable state

The condition in which the intended task can actually be performed.

IN USE define the usable state

latency

Time between a defined initiating event and response.

IN USE measure latency

Precision check

The empirical rule here is at least 95 of 100 runs within 2 seconds, with every run within 5 seconds and no errors. It is not an average-time target. A different percentile calculation convention should not silently replace the agreed count-based test.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

response-time threshold

A specified boundary for an acceptable duration.

IN USE set the response-time threshold

percentile

A position in a distribution defined by a proportion of observations.

IN USE report the percentile basis

tail latency

Response times in the slower part of a distribution.

IN USE monitor tail latency

timeout

A defined limit after which an operation stops waiting.

IN USE specify timeout behavior

error state

A condition showing that the requested operation did not complete as intended.

IN USE handle the error state

empty state

The interface shown when no relevant content is available.

IN USE design the empty state

edge case

An unusual or limiting situation that requires defined behavior.

IN USE cover edge cases

happy path

The intended successful sequence without exceptional conditions.

IN USE test the happy path

testability

The ability to evaluate a requirement with a defined check.

IN USE improve testability

ambiguity

Wording that allows conflicting interpretations.

IN USE remove ambiguity

acceptance test

A test evaluating agreed acceptance conditions.

IN USE run the acceptance test

completion evidence

Records supporting a claim that required work is complete.

IN USE attach completion evidence

Precision check

The trial passes this criterion: 96 exceeds the required 95, and the four slower runs still finish before 5 seconds. The evidence applies to the fixed dataset and profile N. Other environments and the remaining completion requirements are not established by this result.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

CLARIFY THE USER STATE

"The story concerns an authorized editor."

DEFINE THE START

"Start the clock at the navigation click."

FIX THE TEST DATA

"Use the agreed 1,000-record dataset."

STATE THE MAIN THRESHOLD

"At least 95 of 100 runs must finish within 2 seconds."

REPLACE THE ADJECTIVE

"Quickly needs a measurable timing rule."

DEFINE THE FINISH

"Stop when the records and primary action are usable."

NAME THE ENVIRONMENT

"Run under test profile N."

BOUND THE SLOW RUNS

"Every run must finish within 5 seconds."

Quickly

A preference until the measurement and limit are defined.

Loaded

Could mean visual, network, or usable completion; specify it.

Within

Includes the stated boundary unless the agreed rule says otherwise.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

INCLUDE FAILURE BEHAVIOR

"The test must complete without an error."

DISTINGUISH STATISTICS

"An average does not establish the required run count."

KEEP THE SCOPE

"This result applies to the defined test conditions."

PRESERVE OPEN WORK

"The remaining completion checks are still open."

AVOID A CONVENIENT PROXY

"A visible loading shell is not a usable records page."

REPORT THE EVIDENCE

"Ninety-six runs met 2 seconds; all met the ceiling."

SEPARATE COMPLETION LAYERS

"This acceptance criterion does not replace the Definition of Done."

CLOSE THE STORY CAREFULLY

"Attach the evidence before changing the completion status."

Average

Does not describe every run or the slow tail.

Accepted

Specify which criterion or work item was accepted.

Done

Requires the applicable completion standard, not only one passing test.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which criterion matches the agreed performance rule?

- A** At least 95 of 100 defined navigations usable within 2 seconds, all within 5, without errors
- B** Average navigation time below 2 seconds, with every run below 5
- C** At least 95 loading shells visible within 2 seconds, with no request errors
- D** All 100 navigations usable within 5 seconds, regardless of the two-second count

2. What if only 94 runs meet 2 seconds, while all finish before 5 seconds without errors?

- A** The stated criterion fails.
- B** It passes because the slow ceiling is met.
- C** It passes because 94 is close to 95.
- D** No conclusion is possible about the supplied count rule.

3. Why time until the primary action is usable?

- A** The user must be able to perform the intended task, not merely see a loading shell.
- B** A visual placeholder always proves the task can be completed.
- C** Network start and task readiness are identical by definition.
- D** The dataset size becomes irrelevant once anything appears.

4. What can Eva say after the actual trial?

- A** The whole increment automatically meets all quality requirements.
- B** The four slower runs were errors despite completing within the ceiling.
- C** This criterion passed under profile N; other completion checks remain open.
- D** Every possible user environment is proven fast.

Answers and explanations: [page 89](#).

Quickly needs a clock and a test condition

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Definition of Done / acceptance criterion / response-time threshold / happy path / test profile / completion evidence / acceptance test / usable state / test fixture / Tail latency

- 01 **Eva:** The story says an authorized editor should open the records page quickly. Engineering asked what quickly means, and I can see that we have left too much room for interpretation.
- 02 **Omar:** Let us define an ¹ _____ tied to the task. What event starts the timing, and what must be usable before we say the page has finished loading?
- 03 **Eva:** Start at the navigation click. Finish when the records are available and the primary action works, not when the user sees only a loading shell.
- 04 **Omar:** That defines the ² _____. A visible placeholder is not enough because the editor still cannot perform the intended task at that point.
- 05 **Eva:** We should fix the data as well. Let us use the agreed one-thousand-record dataset so a smaller empty page does not stand in for the actual check.
- 06 **Omar:** Use that ³ _____ with profile N. The evidence needs its configuration attached so another reviewer can understand what was measured and repeat the check appropriately.
- 07 **Eva:** For the main threshold, I propose that at least ninety-five of one hundred navigations finish within two seconds. We should also define what happens to the slower runs.
- 08 **Omar:** Add a ⁴ _____ of five seconds for every run, with no errors. That prevents a good fast-run count from concealing an unacceptable slow tail.
- 09 **Eva:** The dashboard gives me an average. Could you send the individual run counts as well? Otherwise I cannot check our ninety-five-out-of-a-hundred rule.
- 10 **Omar:** Correct. ⁵ _____ matters to the experience too. Keep the exact rule in the story rather than replace it with a different summary statistic during reporting.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Eva:** The trial produced ninety-six runs within two seconds. The other four finished within four point five seconds, and there were no errors.
- 12 **Omar:** Then this ⁶ _____ passes on the supplied result. Ninety-six meets the minimum, and all one hundred remain within the separate ceiling without an error.
- 13 **Eva:** I can report that clearly, but I should not imply that every device, network, or dataset has been tested. The result belongs to the agreed setup.
- 14 **Omar:** Keep the ⁷ _____ visible. The conclusion applies to profile N and the defined data, not automatically to every environment a future user might have.
- 15 **Eva:** Can I mark the performance criterion passed and leave the story open? We still have completion checks outstanding, and I do not want to hide them.
- 16 **Omar:** Exactly. The ⁸ _____ is a separate completion standard where the team uses Scrum. One story-specific criterion does not replace the agreed quality requirements for the increment.
- 17 **Eva:** We should preserve the distinction between an ordinary successful path and the other states the product must handle. This test did not define every exceptional situation.
- 18 **Omar:** Yes. The ⁹ _____ is not the entire behavior of the product. Keep the remaining checks visible rather than let one useful test stand for everything.
- 19 **Eva:** I will attach the results, keep the unresolved checks open, and use the exact criterion in the next review. That should end the debate over what quickly means here.
- 20 **Omar:** The ¹⁰ _____ will then support a precise status. We have a measurable requirement and a passing result within scope, without quietly changing the meaning of done.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. acceptance criterion | 2. usable state | 3. test fixture | 4. response-time threshold | 5. Tail latency | 6. acceptance test | 7. test profile | 8. Definition of Done | 9. happy path | 10. completion evidence

A ceiling does not replace the main rule

F Say it

A test requires at least 95 of 100 runs within 2 seconds and all within 5 seconds without errors. The result is 93 within 2 seconds; the remaining seven finish within 4 seconds without errors.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

seconds / 95 / fails / 93

Tester: "The fast-run count is ¹ _____."

Product: "The required fast-run count is at least ² _____."

Tester: "The overall criterion ³ _____."

Product: "The recorded timing unit is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 90

1. 93 | 2. 95 | 3. fails | 4. seconds

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10. Stress usable, at least 95, and every run.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Keep criterion passed distinct from story complete.
3. Check the transfer. Read 93 and 95 distinctly, then stress fails in the conclusion.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

More signups, fewer completed setups

A Read the situation

04

Explain opposing funnel movements using aligned cohorts, counts, rates, and an explicit limit on causal interpretation.

Analyst Imani and growth lead Alex compare two fully matured signup cohorts using the same seven-day setup-completion definition. The earlier cohort has 1,000 signups and 600 completions; the later cohort has 1,500 signups and 500 completions. Event counts are verified. A campaign ran during the later period, but other conditions were not controlled, and no causal attribution is established. Alex calls the campaign a complete success. Imani must explain acquisition growth alongside the decline in completed setups and completion rate.

PEOPLE / Alex: Growth lead | Imani: Product analyst

REPORT THE WHOLE DEFINED OUTCOME

Different teams may optimize different stages of a funnel. Acknowledge the stage that improved, then show what happened at the next meaningful outcome. Use aligned time windows and denominators so a discussion about success does not become a contest between selectively chosen metrics.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. How did signup count change?

- A It rose from 1,000 to 1,500, a 50% increase.
- C It stayed at 1,000.

- B It fell from 600 to 500.
- D It rose by 500 percentage points.

2. How did completed setup count change?

- A It rose from 1,000 to 1,500.
- C It rose to 1,500 because every signup completed.

- B It remained at 600.
- D It fell from 600 to 500.

3. What makes the time windows comparable here?

- A The campaign name replaces the observation period.
- C The later cohort is measured only on its first day.

- B Both cohorts have completed the same seven-day observation window.
- D Each cohort uses a different definition of setup.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

funnel

A defined sequence of steps toward a product outcome.

IN USE analyze the funnel

signup

A recorded account-registration event under the stated definition.

IN USE count valid signups

activation

A defined early milestone indicating initial product value.

IN USE define activation

setup completion

Completion of the specified initial configuration steps.

IN USE measure setup completion

conversion rate

The share of an eligible population completing a defined action.

IN USE calculate conversion rate

cohort

A group sharing a defined starting event or characteristic.

IN USE compare signup cohorts

observation window

The period during which outcomes are counted.

IN USE align the observation window

mature cohort

A cohort whose required observation period has elapsed.

IN USE use mature cohorts

event definition

The rules specifying when an analytics event is recorded.

IN USE maintain event definitions

instrumentation

The implementation used to collect product events and measurements.

IN USE verify instrumentation

event property

A recorded attribute attached to an event.

IN USE validate event properties

unique user

A distinct user under the stated identity rule.

IN USE count unique users

Precision check

Signups rose 50%, but completed setups fell by 100, about 16.67% relative to 600. Completion rates fell from 60% to about 33.33%, a decline of about 26.67 percentage points. Neither the count nor the rate alone describes the entire funnel.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

deduplication

Removing repeated records of the same defined event or entity.

IN USE apply deduplication

denominator

The eligible total used to calculate a rate.

IN USE verify the denominator

drop-off

Loss of users between defined funnel steps.

IN USE locate funnel drop-off

cohort maturity

The extent to which a cohort has completed its observation period.

IN USE check cohort maturity

segmentation

Dividing data into relevant user or context groups.

IN USE segment by acquisition channel

channel mix

The composition of traffic from different acquisition sources.

IN USE examine channel mix

attribution

Assignment of credit for an outcome under a stated method.

IN USE qualify campaign attribution

retention

Continued use or return under a defined time and activity rule.

IN USE measure retention

leading indicator

A measure expected to precede a later outcome.

IN USE validate a leading indicator

lagging indicator

A measure reflecting an outcome after relevant activity occurs.

IN USE report a lagging indicator

guardrail metric

A measure used to detect unacceptable side effects.

IN USE monitor guardrail metrics

metric contract

An agreed definition of a metric's event, population, and calculation.

IN USE document the metric contract

Precision check

Both seven-day windows are complete, so the later cohort is not simply younger in this case. The numbers are verified, but their causes remain unestablished. Channel mix, product friction, and other explanations need investigation rather than being asserted from the two totals.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE ACQUISITION

"Signups increased from 1,000 to 1,500."

GIVE THE EARLIER RATE

"The earlier completion rate was 60%."

NAME THE RATE DIFFERENCE

"That is a decline of approximately 26.67 percentage points."

CONFIRM TIMING

"Both cohorts have a full seven-day window."

STATE THE NEXT OUTCOME

"Completed setups fell from 600 to 500."

GIVE THE LATER RATE

"The later completion rate was approximately 33.33%."

KEEP COUNTS VISIBLE

"We have 100 fewer completed setups despite more signups."

CONFIRM DEFINITIONS

"The setup-completion definition is unchanged."

Success

Specify the objective and stage used to judge it.

Conversion

Needs a starting population, event, and time window.

Users

Define identity and avoid counting repeated events as people.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A BLANKET SUCCESS LABEL

"Acquisition improved, but the downstream outcome worsened."

ASK ABOUT THE MIX

"Did the composition of acquisition channels change?"

PROTECT THE DENOMINATOR

"Use eligible signups from the same cohort."

DEFINE THE NEXT ANALYSIS

"Segment the funnel and check the relevant step-level evidence."

SEPARATE EVIDENCE FROM CAUSE

"The comparison does not isolate the campaign's effect."

LOCATE THE FRICTION

"Which setup step accounts for the observed drop-off?"

AVOID IMMATURE COMPARISONS

"Do not compare a one-day cohort with a complete seven-day cohort."

CLOSE THE UPDATE

"Report acquisition, completion count, completion rate, and the causal limitation."

Drop-off

Locate the step; a total alone does not identify the obstacle.

Attributed

Depends on a method and is not automatically causal proof.

Mature

Describes observation time, not product-market maturity.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which summary represents both movements?

- A** The campaign was a complete success because signups rose.
- B** Setup completion improved because the denominator was larger.
- C** The later cohort had not completed its observation window.
- D** Signups increased, while completed setups and the setup-completion rate declined.

2. What is the later setup-completion rate?

- A** Approximately 33.33%
- B** 50%
- C** 60%
- D** 150%

3. What is the approximate rate decline in percentage points?

- A** 16.67
- B** 50.00
- C** 100.00
- D** 26.67

4. Which causal statement is supported?

- A** A specific product bug is already established as the cause.
- B** Verified counts automatically prove the marketing explanation.
- C** The campaign's causal effect is not isolated by this comparison.
- D** The campaign definitely caused all setup losses.

Answers and explanations: [page 91](#).

More signups, fewer completed setups

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

segmentation / conversion rate / attribution / channel mix / funnel / mature cohort / setup completion / drop-off / instrumentation / denominator

- 01 **Alex:** Signups increased from one thousand to fifteen hundred during the campaign period. I called that a complete success in the update, but you flagged the setup numbers.
- 02 **Imani:** The ¹ _____ shows a mixed result. Completed setups fell from six hundred to five hundred, even though more people entered at the signup stage.
- 03 **Alex:** I want to make sure the later group has had enough time. Comparing a new cohort with an older one could make completion look worse simply because users are still setting up.
- 04 **Imani:** Each is a ² _____ in this comparison. Both have a full seven-day window, and the setup-completion definition is the same in both periods.
- 05 **Alex:** Then the counts describe a real difference in the recorded outcome, not merely an incomplete observation window. We gained five hundred signups but lost one hundred completed setups.
- 06 **Imani:** Correct. Keep the ³ _____ with each rate. The earlier rate is six hundred divided by one thousand, while the later is five hundred divided by fifteen hundred.
- 07 **Alex:** That is sixty percent before and about thirty-three point three three percent later. The decline in the rate is larger than the decline in the completion count.
- 08 **Imani:** Yes. The ⁴ _____ fell by about twenty-six point six seven percentage points. The count and the rate answer related but different questions.
- 09 **Alex:** I have sixteen point six seven percent in my slide. That is the fall in completed setups, not the change in conversion rate. I need separate labels.
- 10 **Imani:** Exactly. State ⁵ _____ in both forms when needed: five hundred completions and roughly thirty-three percent of signups. Neither should disappear behind the favorable acquisition headline.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Alex:** Could the campaign have attracted people who were less ready to configure the product? That seems plausible, but we have not examined the composition of the new signups.
- 12 **Imani:** Investigate ⁶ _____ and other relevant differences. Plausibility is a reason to analyze, not enough to assign the entire decline to the campaign.
- 13 **Alex:** Can we break setup into steps for the next review? I can see the loss in the total, but not where people got stuck.
- 14 **Imani:** Locate the ⁷ _____ using the appropriate step-level evidence. A product problem, a changed audience, and other explanations need different supporting records.
- 15 **Alex:** The event counts have been verified for this comparison. That removes one data-quality concern, but it does not make the business explanation automatic.
- 16 **Imani:** Correct. Verified ⁸ _____ supports trust in the observation. It does not show which uncontrolled difference between the periods caused the outcome.
- 17 **Alex:** The next analysis can compare relevant channels and user groups while keeping the seven-day definition fixed. We should not change the metric halfway through to recover a favorable result.
- 18 **Imani:** Use ⁹ _____ with a clear purpose and consistent definitions. It can reveal where the problem is concentrated without pretending that every descriptive split proves causality.
- 19 **Alex:** I will revise the update to say acquisition improved but the downstream completion outcome worsened. The campaign's overall contribution remains a question for analysis, not a settled success claim.
- 20 **Imani:** That qualifies ¹⁰ _____ appropriately. The team can acknowledge the signup gain and address the completion decline using the same honest account of the evidence.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. funnel | 2. mature cohort | 3. denominator | 4. conversion rate | 5. setup completion | 6. channel mix | 7. drop-off | 8. instrumentation | 9. segmentation | 10. attribution

A bigger entrance, a smaller outcome

F Say it

Two mature seven-day cohorts use the same definition. The first has 200 signups and 100 setup completions. The second has 400 signups and 80 completions. The cause is not established.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

30 / unestablished / 20 / 50

Analyst: "The earlier completion rate was ¹ _____ percent."

Growth: "The later rate was ² _____ percent."

Analyst: "The rate declined by ³ _____ percentage points."

Growth: "The cause remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 92

1. 50 | 2. 20 | 3. 30 | 4. unestablished

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10. Keep signup counts and completion rates clearly separated.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress possible explanations without making them causes.
3. Check the transfer. Read each rate and the percentage-point decline with its unit.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A day-one lead is not a final winner

A Read the situation

Discuss interim experiment results without changing the decision rule after seeing favorable data, while preserving guardrail monitoring.

05

Product manager Jules and experimentation analyst Priya review day one of a randomized test. Control A has 100 conversions from 1,000 eligible users; variant B has 120 from 1,000. The pre-agreed fixed-horizon plan requires 14 days and at least 10,000 eligible users per arm before the final analysis. No sequential early-success rule is approved. The safety guardrail pauses an arm if its defined error rate exceeds 3%; current B errors are 1.2%. Data-quality checks are clear so far. Jules wants to announce B as the winner.

PEOPLE / Jules: Product manager | Priya: Experimentation analyst

DO NOT REWRITE THE FINISH LINE AFTER SEEING THE SCORE

Interim data can support monitoring and investigation without establishing a final decision. State the planned analysis method and the difference between an early-success claim and a guardrail response. Waiting for planned evidence must never be confused with ignoring harm or a data-quality failure.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What are the observed conversion rates?

A A is 1% and B is 1.2%.

B Both are 20%.

C A is 10% and B is 12%.

D A is 100% and B is 120%.

2. Which final-analysis prerequisites remain unmet?

A Fourteen days and at least 10,000 users per arm

B A day-one screenshot only

C A shared denominator of 1,000

D The current absence of a guardrail breach

3. Does B currently exceed the specified error guardrail?

A No; 1.2% is below 3%.

B Yes; any nonzero error rate triggers this rule.

C Yes; conversion is above 10%.

D The guardrail applies only after fourteen days.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

A/B test

A randomized comparison between defined alternatives.

IN USE run an A/B test

control arm

The experiment group receiving the reference experience.

IN USE define the control arm

treatment arm

The group receiving the changed experience.

IN USE monitor the treatment arm

random assignment

Allocation to groups by a defined random process.

IN USE verify random assignment

unit of randomization

The entity assigned to an experiment group, such as a user.

IN USE define the unit of randomization

eligibility rule

A condition determining which entities enter the test or analysis.

IN USE apply eligibility rules

exposure event

The recorded event indicating encounter with the tested experience.

IN USE validate the exposure event

primary metric

The main preselected measure for the experiment decision.

IN USE specify the primary metric

guardrail

A predefined boundary protecting against unacceptable effects.

IN USE monitor the guardrail

fixed-horizon test

A test analyzed under a preplanned endpoint rather than opportunistic stopping.

IN USE follow the fixed-horizon plan

sequential testing

A statistical approach designed for valid repeated decision opportunities.

IN USE use an approved sequential method

stopping rule

A predefined condition for ending or pausing an experiment.

IN USE follow the stopping rule

Precision check

The observed difference is 2 percentage points, or a 20% relative increase from the 10% control rate. These are descriptive day-one figures. No final significance conclusion is supplied, and the pre-agreed time and sample requirements are not met.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

minimum sample

The smallest planned analysis population on the stated basis.

IN USE reach the minimum sample

minimum detectable effect

The effect size a planned test is designed to detect at stated power.

IN USE specify the minimum detectable effect

statistical power

The probability of detecting a specified effect under the test assumptions.

IN USE assess statistical power

confidence interval

An interval produced by a method with stated coverage properties.

IN USE report a confidence interval

p-value

A probability under the null model of results at least as extreme as observed.

IN USE interpret the p-value carefully

false positive

An erroneous rejection of a true null hypothesis under the stated test.

IN USE control false-positive risk

multiple testing

Conducting more than one statistical comparison or decision opportunity.

IN USE account for multiple testing

sample ratio mismatch

A difference from expected group allocation large enough to flag a validity concern.

IN USE investigate sample ratio mismatch

novelty effect

A temporary response associated with encountering something new.

IN USE assess novelty effects

day-of-week effect

Variation associated with the weekday composition of observations.

IN USE examine day-of-week effects

interim result

A result observed before the planned final decision point.

IN USE qualify interim results

practical significance

The operational importance of an effect, separate from statistical evidence.

IN USE assess practical significance

Precision check

A fixed-horizon success decision differs from an active guardrail response. The supplied guardrail is not breached at 1.2%, but it must still be monitored. Valid sequential methods can support different rules; none is approved for early success in this case.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

GIVE THE COUNTS

"A has 100 conversions and B has 120, each from 1,000 users."

SEPARATE EFFECT EXPRESSIONS

"The difference is two percentage points, or 20% relative."

RECALL THE PLAN

"Final analysis requires fourteen days and the planned sample."

REJECT A PREMATURE HEADLINE

"B is ahead in the observed data, not yet a final winner."

STATE THE RATES

"The observed rates are 10% and 12%."

QUALIFY MATURITY

"This is a day-one result."

KEEP BOTH PREREQUISITES

"The minimum is 10,000 eligible users per arm."

AVOID OPPORTUNISTIC STOPPING

"We have no approved early-success rule."

Winner

A decision label that needs the planned evidence and rule.

Lift

Specify absolute percentage points or relative percent.

Peeking

Repeated inspection becomes a statistical issue when it changes decision behavior without an appropriate method.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

PRESERVE MONITORING

"Continue checking guardrails and data quality throughout."

DISTINGUISH DECISIONS

"A harm-based pause is different from declaring success."

AVOID INVENTED CERTAINTY

"The counts alone do not supply a final significance conclusion."

STATE THE NEXT READOUT

"Report the interim figures with the remaining evidence requirements."

APPLY THE ACTUAL THRESHOLD

"The current 1.2% error rate is below the 3% guardrail."

ASK ABOUT VALIDITY

"Have allocation and event checks identified a problem?"

CONSIDER REPRESENTATIVENESS

"One day may not reflect the planned weekday mix."

CLOSE THE DECISION

"Keep the final rollout decision pending the agreed analysis."

Guardrail

Remains active during the test, not only at its endpoint.

Significant

Distinguish statistical evidence from practical importance.

Minimum

A requirement to meet, not a target to quietly lower after favorable data.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which update is justified?

- A** The 20% relative difference proves every user segment benefits.
- B** The experiment can ignore all guardrails until day fourteen.
- C** B leads descriptively on day one; the planned final-analysis requirements are unmet.
- D** B is the final winner because 120 exceeds 100.

2. What is the relative increase from 10% to 12%?

- A** 2%
- B** 12%
- C** 120%
- D** 20%

3. What should happen if the defined guardrail is later exceeded?

- A** Follow the pre-agreed pause and investigation rule.
- B** Keep running regardless because the horizon is fixed.
- C** Declare B the winner to avoid recording the problem.
- D** Remove the error metric after seeing it worsen.

4. Why not stop for success simply because B leads today?

- A** A randomized test can never have interim monitoring.
- B** Every day-one difference is necessarily false.
- C** Fourteen days guarantees statistical significance for every sample.
- D** The fixed-horizon plan has no approved early-success method.

Answers and explanations: [page 93](#).

A day-one lead is not a final winner

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

stopping rule / minimum sample / control arm / practical significance / sample ratio mismatch / fixed-horizon test / interim result / novelty effect / Sequential testing / guardrail

- 01 **Jules:** B has one hundred twenty conversions and A has one hundred, with one thousand eligible users in each group. Can we announce a winner before the weekly product review?
- 02 **Priya:** Call it an ¹ _____. B is ahead in the day-one data, but the final-analysis requirements in our plan have not been met.
- 03 **Jules:** The observed rates are twelve percent and ten percent. I can describe that as a two-percentage-point difference, or twenty percent relative to the control rate.
- 04 **Priya:** Correct, and keep the ² _____ clear. Those expressions describe the observed difference; neither one supplies a final significance conclusion or a guarantee of rollout benefit.
- 05 **Jules:** The plan calls for fourteen days and at least ten thousand eligible users per arm. We are short of both requirements after the first day.
- 06 **Priya:** This is a ³ _____. We should not redefine its success decision because today's numbers look attractive, especially when no alternative early-success method has been approved.
- 07 **Jules:** What if B is still ahead tomorrow and we call it then? I want to avoid waiting unnecessarily, but would that change the analysis?
- 08 **Priya:** That changes the ⁴ _____. Repeated opportunities to declare success need an appropriate statistical method, not an improvised rule added after seeing the data.
- 09 **Jules:** I understand that success stopping needs discipline. But we should still watch for a poor experience while the test runs, rather than wait until the final day.
- 10 **Priya:** Absolutely. The ⁵ _____ stays active. Our defined error rule pauses an arm above three percent; B is currently at one point two percent, so it has not breached that threshold.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

05

- 11 **Jules:** If that error rate later crosses the threshold, we follow the pause and investigation process. The fixed horizon does not require us to ignore that change.
- 12 **Priya:** Correct. ⁶ _____ could support different success rules if properly planned, but it is not the method approved here. Guardrail monitoring is still part of this plan.
- 13 **Jules:** Who is watching assignment and event quality while it runs? I do not want us discussing a conversion gain that turns out to be a logging problem.
- 14 **Priya:** Yes. Investigate a ⁷ _____ if one is flagged, alongside the relevant event checks. The current checks are clear so far, which is a status rather than a permanent guarantee.
- 15 **Jules:** One day also gives us only a narrow time slice. Different weekday behavior or a temporary reaction to the new experience could affect what we see.
- 16 **Priya:** A ⁸ _____ is one possible concern. Do not claim it explains this result, but do not assume the first day's response represents the full planned period either.
- 17 **Jules:** At the final readout, we will still need to understand whether the effect matters enough to justify rollout, not only whether the analysis meets its statistical decision rule.
- 18 **Priya:** Assess ⁹ _____ alongside the planned statistical evidence and guardrails. A decision needs the relevant magnitude, uncertainty, and consequences rather than a single attractive percentage.
- 19 **Jules:** My update will give the counts and observed lead, note the remaining time and sample requirements, and keep the rollout decision pending while monitoring continues.
- 20 **Priya:** That respects the ¹⁰ _____ and the approved method. We can communicate useful progress without turning the first readout into a conclusion the experiment has not yet earned.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. interim result | 2. control arm | 3. fixed-horizon test | 4. stopping rule | 5. guardrail | 6. Sequential testing | 7. sample ratio mismatch | 8. novelty effect | 9. practical significance | 10. minimum sample

The arithmetic is not the decision rule

F Say it

On day two of a fixed-horizon test, A converts 40 of 500 users and B converts 50 of 500. The final time and sample requirements are unmet, and no early-success rule is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

25 / undecided / 10 / 8

Analyst: "A converts ¹ _____ percent."

Product: "B converts ² _____ percent."

Analyst: "The relative increase is ³ _____ percent."

Product: "The final winner remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 94

1. 8 | 2. 10 | 3. 25 | 4. undecided

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10. Contrast observed lead with final winner.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress that guardrail monitoring continues.
3. Check the transfer. Read 8%, 10%, and 25% with the correct comparison each time.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The software is ready; the support handoff is not

A Read the situation

Coordinate a release review by naming the missing operational prerequisite, its owner, and the distinction between review and launch approval.

06

Release manager Ana and product marketer Rob prepare a Friday 10 a.m. launch review for a workspace-permissions update. Engineering checks are complete and the rollback rehearsal passed. The local launch checklist also requires migration notes delivered to Support and confirmed usable by its lead. Those notes have not been delivered. Ana can assign delivery for Thursday 3 p.m. and request Support review, but no waiver or launch approval exists. Rob wants to send the customer announcement now.

PEOPLE / Ana: Release manager | Rob: Product marketer

TREAT THE HANDOFF AS PART OF READINESS

Customer-facing teams need the information required to handle the change, not merely proof that engineering finished coding. Name what is missing and how it will be checked. A planned review can stay on the calendar while the launch decision remains conditional.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which readiness item is missing?

- | | |
|------------------------------------|--|
| A Engineering checks | B A successful rollback rehearsal |
| C A scheduled Friday review | D Migration notes delivered to Support and confirmed usable |

2. What does Friday 10 a.m. represent?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A A waiver deadline that automatically removes the checklist item | B The planned launch review |
| C An already approved launch | D A guaranteed completed migration for all customers |

3. What can Ana do now?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Assign note delivery and request Support review. | B Declare a waiver without authority. |
| C Treat an undelivered document as accepted. | D Announce approval that does not exist. |

Answers and explanations: page 95.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

release readiness

The state of meeting requirements for a defined release decision.

IN USE assess release readiness

go-to-market

Coordinated work to bring a product or change to its intended audience.

IN USE align the go-to-market plan

launch checklist

The required items reviewed before a launch decision.

IN USE complete the launch checklist

migration notes

Guidance explaining how users or teams move to a changed version or behavior.

IN USE deliver migration notes

release notes

A summary of changes in a defined release.

IN USE publish release notes

support enablement

Preparing support staff to assist users of the change.

IN USE complete support enablement

known issue

A documented problem with a stated status and impact.

IN USE disclose known issues

workaround

A defined alternative route around a known limitation.

IN USE document the workaround

rollback

Returning to a prior state under a defined recovery procedure.

IN USE rehearse rollback

rollout

Making a change available to a defined population.

IN USE stage the rollout

feature flag

A control enabling or disabling a capability for defined conditions or users.

IN USE configure a feature flag

go/no-go decision

A formal decision about whether a planned release proceeds.

IN USE record the go/no-go decision

Precision check

Engineering completion and a passed rollback rehearsal are positive readiness facts. They do not satisfy the separate Support requirement. The checklist calls for both delivery and confirmation that the notes are usable; a sent attachment alone would not necessarily close it.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

launch gate

A required condition before proceeding to a launch stage.

IN USE satisfy the launch gate

operational readiness

Preparedness of the people and processes supporting live operation.

IN USE verify operational readiness

runbook

Documented instructions for a defined operational process.

IN USE update the runbook

escalation path

The route for obtaining higher-level help or authority.

IN USE confirm the escalation path

customer announcement

Communication informing customers about a change or availability.

IN USE approve the customer announcement

release owner

The role coordinating or accountable for the release under local rules.

IN USE identify the release owner

dependency owner

The person accountable for a required input.

IN USE name the dependency owner

readiness evidence

Records showing that a required release condition has been met.

IN USE attach readiness evidence

acceptance confirmation

A recipient's recorded acknowledgment that an input meets the agreed need.

IN USE obtain acceptance confirmation

contingency

A planned response if an expected condition is not met.

IN USE agree the contingency

launch hold

A restriction preventing the launch from proceeding.

IN USE communicate a launch hold

post-launch monitoring

Observation of defined product and operational signals after release.

IN USE plan post-launch monitoring

Precision check

Thursday 3 p.m. is a proposed delivery deadline for the missing input. Friday 10 a.m. is a review, not automatic approval. The customer announcement must not imply a launch decision before the responsible process has made one.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE COMPLETED WORK

"Engineering checks are complete and rollback was rehearsed."

QUOTE THE ACTUAL GATE

"The notes must be delivered and confirmed usable."

ASSIGN THE INPUT

"Name the owner for Thursday's note delivery."

AVOID A FALSE HANDOFF

"Sent does not automatically mean accepted."

NAME THE OPEN ITEM

"Support has not received the required migration notes."

SEPARATE TEAM READINESS

"Code readiness is not the whole launch checklist."

REQUEST RECIPIENT REVIEW

"Ask the Support lead to confirm usability."

KEEP THE REVIEW

"Friday's go/no-go review can remain scheduled."

Ready

Specify engineering, operational, commercial, or overall release readiness.

Delivered

A transmission event, not always evidence of recipient acceptance.

Usable

A recipient-facing condition, not a file-exists check.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

QUALIFY THE LAUNCH

"Launch approval is still pending."

CLARIFY THE CONTENT

"The notes need the changed permission behavior and support route."

DEFINE THE CONTINGENCY

"State what happens if the required confirmation is missing."

COORDINATE MESSAGES

"Give Marketing and Support the same status."

HOLD THE ANNOUNCEMENT

"Do not announce availability before the release decision."

KEEP AUTHORITY CLEAR

"No waiver has been approved."

PRESERVE THE EVIDENCE

"Attach Support's confirmation to the readiness record."

CLOSE THE REVIEW REQUEST

"Bring completed evidence and remaining blockers to the decision owner."

06

Scheduled

A planned event, not a completed decision.

Announced

Creates customer expectations and should match actual approval.

Waived

Requires the appropriate authorized exception, not an informal assumption.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

06

1. Which readiness statement is accurate?

- A** Friday's meeting automatically grants permission to announce.
- B** Engineering is ready; the required Support handoff remains incomplete.
- C** The whole launch is approved because rollback passed.
- D** Support's missing notes are complete because someone intends to send them.

2. What evidence closes the stated Support item?

- A** Only a draft stored where Support cannot access it
- B** Only a passed code test unrelated to migration guidance
- C** Delivery of the notes and the Support lead's usability confirmation
- D** Only a promise that a document will exist

3. Which announcement decision fits the facts?

- A** Describe the missing notes as waived without authorization.
- B** Promise every customer a completed migration before review.
- C** Keep the customer availability announcement pending the release decision.
- D** Announce approval immediately because the review is scheduled.

4. What should happen if confirmation is still missing at the review?

- A** Mark the gate complete to protect the calendar.
- B** Assume silence from Support means acceptance.
- C** Remove the requirement after the meeting begins.
- D** Present the unresolved gate and follow the authorized go/no-go process.

Answers and explanations: [page 95](#).

The software is ready; the support handoff is not

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Support enablement / launch checklist / readiness evidence / acceptance confirmation / dependency owner / contingency / migration notes / go/no-go decision / operational readiness / customer announcement

- 01 **Rob:** Engineering says the workspace-permissions update is ready, and the rollback rehearsal passed. I would like to send the customer announcement before Friday's review so the campaign can start.
- 02 **Ana:** The ¹ _____ still has an open item. Support has not received the migration notes, and the local requirement also calls for its lead to confirm that they are usable.
- 03 **Rob:** I had treated the notes as a follow-up document rather than part of the release decision. The checklist makes that dependency explicit, so we need to close it.
- 04 **Ana:** Yes. ² _____ is part of this launch. The team needs to explain the changed permissions and route questions, not merely know that a new version exists.
- 05 **Rob:** Can we set Thursday at three as the delivery deadline and ask the Support lead to review the material before the Friday meeting?
- 06 **Ana:** We can assign a ³ _____ and that deadline. We should also confirm who performs the recipient review so delivery does not become an unowned handoff.
- 07 **Rob:** I will coordinate with the author and make sure Support can access the current document. A draft in a private folder would not meet the requirement.
- 08 **Ana:** Correct. The ⁴ _____ need to reach the people using them. Their content should address the change and support route, not just repeat the marketing headline.
- 09 **Rob:** I can show that we sent a file. Are you saying I also need the Support lead to confirm that it answers the migration questions?
- 10 **Ana:** We need ⁵ _____. Sent and accepted are different states here, and the readiness record should preserve both rather than assume silence means the document is sufficient.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Rob:** We can keep Friday's ten o'clock meeting scheduled while those actions proceed. But the invitation should not be read as proof that the launch has already been approved.
- 12 **Ana:** Exactly. It is a ⁶ _____ review. The decision depends on the required evidence and any open items, not on the fact that everyone has accepted the calendar invitation.
- 13 **Rob:** I will prepare the announcement but keep it unsent. Please flag the release decision; I should not infer it from the meeting invitation.
- 14 **Ana:** Keep the ⁷ _____ aligned with the decision. We can prepare coordinated messages now without telling customers a pending change is already approved or available.
- 15 **Rob:** If the notes arrive late or Support finds gaps, we need an explicit response. Otherwise people may assume the engineering result overrides the unfinished handoff.
- 16 **Ana:** Agree the ⁸ _____ with the release owner. The unresolved gate must be presented honestly; no waiver is recorded, and we should not invent one to preserve a preferred date.
- 17 **Rob:** I will ask the Support lead to identify any missing explanation promptly. The author can then address it and bring the final confirmation to the review.
- 18 **Ana:** Attach that ⁹ _____ to the release record. It should show what was delivered and accepted, not merely that an action was assigned to someone.
- 19 **Rob:** Our status can now acknowledge the completed engineering checks while naming the remaining operational work. Marketing, Engineering, and Support will use the same wording.
- 20 **Ana:** That gives an accurate ¹⁰ _____ picture. We can keep preparing for the launch while leaving its approval with the responsible review and the evidence it requires.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. launch checklist | 2. Support enablement | 3. dependency owner | 4. migration notes | 5. acceptance confirmation | 6. go/no-go decision | 7. customer announcement | 8. contingency | 9. readiness evidence | 10. operational readiness

A sent file is only half the gate

F Say it

The checklist requires a migration guide delivered to Support and confirmed usable by its lead. Delivery is recorded, but confirmation is absent. The launch review is tomorrow; no approval is recorded.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

confirmation / approval / delivery / review

Release: "The guide reached Support, so we can record ¹ _____."

Support: "You still need my usability ² _____ before closing that item."

Release: "We will take the open item to the launch ³ _____ tomorrow."

Marketing: "I will keep the availability announcement unsent until we have launch ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 96

1. delivery | 2. confirmation | 3. review | 4. approval

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10. Contrast sent with confirmed usable.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress review, approval, and announcement as separate events.
3. Check the transfer. Read the four handoff terms clearly without adding an approval.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A three-day adapter or a ten-day interface

A Read the situation

Explain a short-term delivery option and its maintenance consequences without hiding compatibility, ownership, or retirement requirements.

Product manager Camille and engineering lead Dev assess a customer request due in five working days. A client-specific adapter is estimated at three days including tests and could support a single-client pilot. A shared API change is estimated at ten days including tests. The adapter duplicates an existing transformation and needs named ownership, monitoring, rollback, and an approved 30-day expiry or extension process. Existing clients must retain their current behavior. Neither option is approved, and no engineering capacity beyond the estimates is confirmed.

PEOPLE / Camille: Product manager | Dev: Engineering lead

07

TRANSLATE DEBT INTO AN OWNED CONSEQUENCE

Technical debt is not a synonym for bad code or an automatic reason to reject a short-term option. Describe what is duplicated, what must be maintained, and how the temporary path ends. A product decision can then weigh timing and consequences without pretending the shortcut is free.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which estimate fits inside the requested five-day window?

- A Both estimates equally
- B Neither can be compared with five days
- C The three-day adapter estimate
- D The ten-day shared API estimate

2. What does the adapter duplicate?

- A A confirmed ten-day capacity allocation
- B An existing transformation
- C The entire customer company
- D A completed approval record

3. Which constraint applies to existing clients?

- A They must all join the pilot automatically.
- B They can be broken without notice because the request is urgent.
- C Their behavior is irrelevant to the shared interface.
- D Their current behavior must be preserved.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

platform capability

A shared function supporting multiple products or consumers.

IN USE invest in platform capability

API

Application programming interface, a defined way for software components to interact.

IN USE define the API contract

API contract

The agreed inputs, outputs, and behavior of an interface.

IN USE preserve the API contract

endpoint

An addressable operation or resource in an interface.

IN USE document the endpoint

request schema

The defined structure and meaning of incoming data.

IN USE validate the request schema

response schema

The defined structure and meaning of returned data.

IN USE preserve the response schema

backward compatibility

Continued support for existing consumers under the stated contract.

IN USE maintain backward compatibility

breaking change

A change that can invalidate existing consumers' expectations.

IN USE identify a breaking change

versioning

Identifying and managing distinct interface or product versions.

IN USE plan API versioning

deprecation

Notice that a capability is discouraged and may be retired under a defined plan.

IN USE communicate deprecation

migration path

The supported route from an old interface or behavior to a new one.

IN USE provide a migration path

adapter

A component translating between interfaces or data forms.

IN USE scope the adapter

Precision check

The three-day estimate fits the five-day request numerically; it is not yet an approved commitment. Its scope is a single-client pilot. The ten-day shared API option exceeds the requested window, so the team must change scope, timing, or the decision rather than hide the difference.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

client-specific logic

Behavior implemented for a particular consumer.

IN USE isolate client-specific logic

duplicated logic

The same rule or transformation maintained in multiple places.

IN USE track duplicated logic

technical debt

Additional future work caused by expedient or inadequate design or implementation.

IN USE make technical debt explicit

maintenance burden

The effort and risk involved in keeping a solution working.

IN USE estimate the maintenance burden

ownership

Clear responsibility for a component or decision.

IN USE assign ownership

observability

The ability to understand a system through its exposed signals.

IN USE provide observability

rollback plan

The defined way to reverse a change if necessary.

IN USE test the rollback plan

expiry condition

A rule stating when a temporary option ends unless explicitly extended.

IN USE set the expiry condition

retirement plan

The agreed work and timing for removing an old or temporary path.

IN USE fund the retirement plan

extension decision

A recorded decision to continue beyond an original limit.

IN USE require an extension decision

blast radius

The scope of users or systems affected by a change or failure.

IN USE limit the blast radius

service-level objective

A defined target for a service measure, abbreviated SLO.

IN USE agree a service-level objective

Precision check

A temporary adapter remains a maintained product path until removed. The 30-day limit needs a named owner and an approved expiry or extension process. Interface compatibility includes behavior and expectations, not just keeping an endpoint name unchanged.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

SET OUT THE OPTIONS

"The adapter is estimated at three days; the shared API work at ten."

NAME THE SHORT-TERM SCOPE

"The adapter would serve one client's pilot."

TRANSLATE THE DEBT

"Both copies would need to stay consistent until retirement."

ASK ABOUT THE CONTRACT

"Would this change alter an existing response or behavior?"

QUALIFY THE ESTIMATE

"Both estimates include tests but are not delivery approvals."

EXPOSE THE DUPLICATION

"It repeats an existing transformation."

PROTECT EXISTING CLIENTS

"Their current behavior must remain supported."

LIMIT EXPOSURE

"Keep the pilot's blast radius explicit."

Quick

Specify what is included and what future work remains.

Temporary

Needs an expiry or retirement decision to have practical meaning.

Debt

Describe its consequence instead of using it as a moral label.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ASSIGN MAINTENANCE

"Who owns the adapter after the first delivery?"

PLAN REVERSAL

"The pilot needs a tested rollback plan."

AVOID SILENT PERMANENCE

"A missed retirement date requires a decision, not an assumption."

KEEP APPROVAL VISIBLE

"Neither approach is approved yet."

REQUIRE MONITORING

"Which signals show that the temporary path is working?"

SET THE LIMIT

"The proposed adapter expires after thirty days unless explicitly extended."

COMPARE HONESTLY

"The durable option needs a longer delivery window."

CLOSE THE PROPOSAL

"Present timing, scope, compatibility, ownership, and retirement together."

Compatible

Includes behavior, not only unchanged field names.

Shared

A wider consumer base can increase both value and change impact.

Estimate

A planning input, not automatically a staffed commitment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which proposal accurately describes the adapter?

- A** A cost-free change with no future maintenance
- B** A ten-day implementation guaranteed within five days
- C** A three-day estimated single-client pilot with required ownership, monitoring, rollback, and expiry controls
- D** A permanent shared interface already approved for every client

2. Why does duplicated transformation logic matter?

- A** Duplication automatically proves every request is unsafe.
- B** A temporary label removes maintenance work.
- C** Existing clients no longer depend on their contract.
- D** Future changes may require both copies to stay consistent.

3. What is a compatibility question?

- A** Can the deadline be renamed to hide the estimate?
- B** Can all older users be assumed to migrate instantly?
- C** Will existing clients receive behavior they can still handle under the current contract?
- D** Does the slide call the work a platform investment?

4. What should happen at the 30-day limit?

- A** Declare the shared API work complete without doing it.
- B** Follow the approved expiry or explicit extension process.
- C** Let the adapter continue forever without ownership.
- D** Assume that temporary means no monitoring is needed.

Answers and explanations: [page 97](#).

A three-day adapter or a ten-day interface

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

breaking change / API contract / Maintenance burden / duplicated logic / ownership / retirement plan / expiry condition / blast radius / adapter / rollback plan

07

- 01 **Camille:** The customer needs a response within five working days. We have a three-day adapter estimate and ten days for shared API work, both including tests. What can we responsibly offer?
- 02 **Dev:** The ¹ _____ could fit the requested window as a single-client pilot. That is an option to assess, not an approved delivery commitment or a solution for every consumer.
- 03 **Camille:** I want to explain why the quicker path has a cost beyond those three days. The estimate says it repeats a transformation we already maintain elsewhere.
- 04 **Dev:** That creates ² _____. If the rule changes, both paths need to stay consistent until the adapter is removed. The customer-specific route cannot become invisible once the pilot starts.
- 05 **Camille:** Then technical debt should be described as that future consistency work and the responsibility to retire the temporary path, not simply as engineers disliking a quick solution.
- 06 **Dev:** Exactly. ³ _____ makes the consequence concrete. We can choose a bounded shortcut deliberately, but we should not present it as having no ongoing owner or cost.
- 07 **Camille:** The shared option also needs to preserve existing clients. We cannot change what they receive merely because the new customer has a different need.
- 08 **Dev:** Review the ⁴ _____. Existing behavior must remain supported. Keeping the same endpoint name would not be enough if we changed the meaning of a field or response.
- 09 **Camille:** We should distinguish a new optional capability from a change that older clients cannot handle. That will help me explain the engineering review in product terms.
- 10 **Dev:** A ⁵ _____ can be behavioral, not just structural. We need to assess the actual consumers and contract rather than promise compatibility from a superficial comparison.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Camille:** One client sounds contained, but can another client hit that path accidentally? I need to understand the boundary and how we will detect a problem.
- 12 **Dev:** Define the ⁶ _____ and the relevant monitoring. Narrow scope is useful only if the implementation and controls actually preserve that boundary.
- 13 **Camille:** Who will support it after delivery? I do not want the team to assume the first implementer will maintain it indefinitely without agreed capacity.
- 14 **Dev:** Assign ⁷ _____ before approval. The proposal must identify who watches the signals, handles issues, and keeps the temporary transformation consistent with the existing one.
- 15 **Camille:** If we switch it off, what happens to that customer? Can we test the return path before offering the pilot, rather than work it out during an incident?
- 16 **Dev:** Include a tested ⁸ _____. The decision needs a practical recovery route, not just confidence that the change is small.
- 17 **Camille:** We proposed a thirty-day limit. At that point the adapter should expire or receive an explicit extension under an approved process, not remain by accident.
- 18 **Dev:** Make that ⁹ _____ part of the proposal. Temporary is only useful language if the end condition has an owner and a decision route.
- 19 **Camille:** I will present the options with the timing difference, the single-client limit, compatibility requirements, and ongoing work. Neither will be described as approved until the relevant review is complete.
- 20 **Dev:** Include the ¹⁰ _____ alongside the estimates. Then the team can decide whether the bounded pilot is worthwhile or whether the customer timeline should move for the shared solution.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. adapter | 2. duplicated logic | 3. Maintenance burden | 4. API contract | 5. breaking change | 6. blast radius | 7. ownership | 8. rollback plan | 9. expiry condition | 10. retirement plan

Temporary needs an ending

F Say it

A single-client adapter is estimated at two days; shared interface work needs eight. The requested window is four days. The adapter requires an owner and expires after 21 days unless explicitly extended. Neither option is approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

8 / 21 / 2 / approval

Product: "The adapter estimate is ¹ _____ days."

Engineering: "The shared option needs ² _____ days."

Product: "The adapter limit is ³ _____ days unless extended."

Engineering: "Both options still need ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 98

1. 2 | 2. 8 | 3. 21 | 4. approval

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10. Stress estimated timing and the compatibility requirement.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Pause before ownership, rollback, and expiry conditions.
3. Check the transfer. Read two, eight, and twenty-one with the correct time basis.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Turn competing opinions into a decision request

A Read the situation

Present a concise recommendation tied to a shared objective while acknowledging evidence limits, displaced work, and decision authority.

Product lead Iris prepares a decision with executive chair Malik. The agreed quarterly objective is to reduce support friction for existing paid teams. Option A is a two-week reliability pilot addressing an error category present in 40 of 100 reviewed support tickets. Those tickets are not 40 distinct customers, and no retention effect is established. Option B is a sales dashboard requested for uncommitted prospects. Capacity allows only one pilot. The agreed criterion favors documented existing-customer friction; the chair makes the decision. Iris recommends A, with B deferred and results reviewed after two weeks.

PEOPLE / Iris: Product lead | Malik: Executive decision chair

08

RECOMMEND CLEARLY WITHOUT OVERSTATING CERTAINTY

Executives need a decision-ready explanation, not a history of every meeting. Lead with the recommendation, connect it to the shared objective and evidence, state the trade-off, and identify the decision requested. Acknowledge the alternative fairly rather than caricaturing the executive who prefers it.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is the shared quarterly objective?

- A Reduce support friction for existing paid teams
- B Maximize every possible feature count
- C Guarantee revenue from uncommitted prospects
- D Prove a retention gain already occurred

2. What does 40 of 100 mean?

- A Forty distinct customers are proven to have churned.
- B Forty percent of all customers have the error.
- C A forty-percent retention improvement is established.
- D Forty reviewed tickets belong to the relevant error category.

3. Who makes the supplied decision?

- A Every prospect automatically
- B Whoever repeats a preference most often
- C Malik, the executive chair
- D Iris alone by sending a recommendation

Answers and explanations: page 99.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

executive narrative

A concise explanation connecting evidence, trade-offs, and a decision.

IN USE shape the executive narrative

decision request

A specific choice or authorization sought from a decision maker.

IN USE state the decision request

shared objective

An agreed outcome used to align competing views.

IN USE confirm the shared objective

decision criterion

A defined basis for evaluating alternatives.

IN USE agree the decision criterion

recommendation

A proposed course of action supported by reasons.

IN USE lead with the recommendation

evidence strength

The degree of support the available information gives a claim.

IN USE qualify evidence strength

customer friction

Difficulty users encounter while trying to achieve a task.

IN USE reduce customer friction

paid team

A customer organization or group with a paid product relationship.

IN USE support existing paid teams

ticket category

A defined grouping of support records by issue type.

IN USE analyze the ticket category

distinct customer

A unique customer under the stated identity rule.

IN USE count distinct customers

retention effect

A change in continued use attributable to a specified intervention.

IN USE evaluate the retention effect

prospect

A potential customer who has not yet made the relevant commitment.

IN USE distinguish prospects from customers

08

Precision check

Forty of 100 reviewed tickets is 40% of those tickets. It is not 40 distinct customers or 40% of the customer population. The case supplies no causal retention effect. A recommendation can be well supported by problem fit while its future impact remains uncertain.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

uncommitted pipeline

Potential business without the stated binding or accepted commitment.

IN USE qualify uncommitted pipeline

pilot scope

The bounded population, work, and duration of a trial.

IN USE define the pilot scope

decision owner

The role authorized to make a specified choice.

IN USE identify the decision owner

displaced work

Work that does not proceed because another option uses capacity.

IN USE name the displaced work

counterargument

A reason offered against a proposed conclusion or action.

IN USE address the counterargument

steelman

Presenting the strongest reasonable version of another position.

IN USE steelman the alternative

assumption check

Review of a premise on which a proposal depends.

IN USE conduct an assumption check

reversibility

The extent to which a decision can be undone at acceptable cost.

IN USE assess reversibility

decision boundary

The scope of what a particular approval does and does not authorize.

IN USE state the decision boundary

success measure

A defined indicator used to evaluate the intended result.

IN USE agree a success measure

follow-up review

A scheduled evaluation of progress or results after a decision.

IN USE schedule the follow-up review

decision record

Documentation of the choice, basis, authority, and conditions.

IN USE preserve the decision record

Precision check

The agreed criterion favors A over B for this one available pilot. That does not prove B has no value or authorize a full rollout. The chair must decide the bounded pilot; the two-week review evaluates results rather than guaranteeing success in advance.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

LEAD WITH THE ACTION

"I recommend the two-week reliability pilot."

STATE THE EVIDENCE

"The error category appears in 40 of 100 reviewed tickets."

LIMIT THE OUTCOME CLAIM

"We have not established a retention effect."

APPLY THE SHARED RULE

"Our criterion favors documented existing-customer friction."

CONNECT THE OBJECTIVE

"It directly addresses documented friction for existing paid teams."

PROTECT THE UNIT

"Those are tickets, not 40 distinct customers."

REPRESENT THE ALTERNATIVE

"The dashboard could support prospect conversations, but the pipeline is uncommitted."

STATE THE TRADE-OFF

"Choosing A defers the sales-dashboard pilot."

08

Recommend

A clear proposal, not an announcement that approval already occurred.

Evidence

State its unit, source, and limits.

Customer

Do not substitute ticket counts for unique organizations.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

NAME THE AUTHORITY

"I am asking the chair to approve this bounded pilot."

INVITE A RELEVANT CHALLENGE

"Which assumption would change your view under the agreed objective?"

SET THE REVIEW

"Review the pilot evidence after two weeks."

RECORD THE DECISION

"Capture the chosen scope, rationale, and owner."

DEFINE THE BOUNDARY

"This is not approval for a full rollout."

AVOID PERSONAL FRAMING

"The disagreement concerns priorities, not the competence of either team."

KEEP THE MEASURE HONEST

"Agree the success measure before interpreting results."

CLOSE THE REQUEST

"Approve or decline the pilot on the stated basis."

08

Pipeline

Potential business is not automatically committed revenue.

Pilot

A bounded trial, not a hidden full rollout.

Review

A point to assess results, not a promise that results will be positive.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which opening is most decision-ready?

- A** I recommend the two-week reliability pilot because it matches our agreed objective and documented ticket evidence.
- B** We have had many interesting meetings and everyone has opinions.
- C** The dashboard sponsor clearly does not care about customers.
- D** Forty tickets prove forty customers will stay forever.

2. How should Iris describe the alternative?

- A** It could support prospect conversations, but the supplied pipeline is uncommitted.
- B** It has no possible value because it is not selected.
- C** It is already guaranteed revenue.
- D** Its sponsor's preference overrides every shared criterion automatically.

3. What does approval of the requested pilot authorize?

- A** Every deferred feature in addition to the pilot
- B** The defined two-week pilot within its agreed scope
- C** An unlimited rollout to every customer
- D** A proven retention improvement

4. Which statement about the ticket evidence is accurate?

- A** It proves the pilot already solved the problem.
- B** It identifies a documented issue category but does not establish distinct-customer count or retention impact.
- C** It proves exactly forty separate organizations are affected.
- D** It is a census of the entire paid population.

Answers and explanations: page 99.

Turn competing opinions into a decision request

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

ticket category / retention effect / recommendation / success measure / displaced work / uncommitted pipeline / shared objective / decision boundary / follow-up review / decision record

08

- 01 **Malik:** We keep debating reliability for customers and a dashboard for prospects. What decision are you asking us to make?
- 02 **Iris:** My ¹ _____ is to approve the two-week reliability pilot. It addresses the documented error category and fits the objective we agreed for existing paid teams.
- 03 **Malik:** State that objective explicitly. The executives have been using different ideas of success, which makes each option sound essential on its own terms.
- 04 **Iris:** The ² _____ is to reduce support friction for current paid teams this quarter. Under that objective, the ticket evidence gives A a more direct basis than uncommitted prospect requests.
- 05 **Malik:** What exactly does the evidence show? I heard someone say forty customers are affected, but the briefing refers to forty tickets out of one hundred reviewed.
- 06 **Iris:** It is a ³ _____ count, not forty distinct customers. The category appears in forty of the hundred reviewed tickets, and we should preserve that unit when presenting the problem.
- 07 **Malik:** Does that also mean the reliability work will improve retention? That would be useful, but I do not want the recommendation to promise a result we have not measured.
- 08 **Iris:** No ⁴ _____ is established. We are proposing to address documented friction, not claiming the ticket count proves a future reduction in customer loss.
- 09 **Malik:** Sales will challenge that. What is the strongest case for their dashboard? Tell me what we give up, not just what supports your recommendation.
- 10 **Iris:** It could support prospect conversations, but the supplied ⁵ _____ is not guaranteed business. That potential matters, yet it is less directly supported under the criterion chosen for this quarter.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Malik:** Capacity permits one pilot. If I approve A, the dashboard pilot does not happen at the same time, and that consequence should be visible to the commercial team.
- 12 **Iris:** I will name the ⁶ _____. B is deferred, not declared worthless. Any later reconsideration should use updated evidence and the available capacity rather than an implied promise that it is already next.
- 13 **Malik:** How broad is the approval you want? I do not want a small pilot decision interpreted as permission to roll out a change across the entire customer base.
- 14 **Iris:** The ⁷ _____ is the defined two-week pilot. We should record its scope and responsible owner, with any wider rollout requiring its own evidence and decision.
- 15 **Malik:** We also need to agree what we will examine afterward. Otherwise each team may select whichever number makes its original preference look right.
- 16 **Iris:** Agree the ⁸ _____ before interpreting the results. It should connect to the friction we are addressing, with the limits of the pilot evidence kept visible.
- 17 **Malik:** Put the result review in for two weeks. Bring the same measures whether the pilot succeeds or disappoints; we need an actual decision at that meeting.
- 18 **Iris:** The ⁹ _____ will show what changed, what remains uncertain, and what decision follows. The review date does not promise a retention result or automatic expansion.
- 19 **Malik:** The request is clear: one bounded pilot, an explicit trade-off, and a defined review. I will decide on that basis and record any conditions.
- 20 **Iris:** I will preserve the ¹⁰ _____ with your choice and conditions. That gives both teams the same account of the decision, including what was approved and what was deferred.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. recommendation | 2. shared objective | 3. ticket category | 4. retention effect | 5. uncommitted pipeline | 6. displaced work | 7. decision boundary | 8. success measure | 9. follow-up review | 10. decision record

Tickets are not customers

F Say it

A team reviews 80 tickets; 20 concern a specific error. Unique-customer counts and retention effects are unknown. The product lead recommends a ten-day pilot, with final approval assigned to the chair.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

approval / 10 / 25 / tickets

08

Product: "The error appears in ¹ _____ percent of reviewed tickets."

Chair: "The unit counted is ² _____."

Product: "The proposed pilot lasts ³ _____ days."

Chair: "The recommendation still requires my ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 100

1. 25 | 2. tickets | 3. 10 | 4. approval

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Read turns 1-10. Stress tickets rather than distinct customers.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Keep pilot approval distinct from full rollout.
3. Check the transfer. Read the 25% ticket result and ten-day request without adding a retention claim.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

What exactly counts as a paid seat?

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Resolve conflicting plan descriptions before a customer sees a price.

A proposed monthly plan costs \$120 including eight editor seats. Each additional editor seat costs \$12 for a full month; viewers are free. Taxes and partial-month changes are outside this example. A draft incorrectly calls every member a paid user. The plan is not launched.

PEOPLE / Mina: Product manager | Theo: Billing analyst

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

seat type / invoice preview / entitlement / proration / included allowance / Grandfathering

- 01 **Theo:** Your plan page says twenty members, but the billing specification counts editors. Which number am I supposed to show in the preview?
- 02 **Mina:** The paid ¹ _____ is editor. Viewers can belong to the workspace without adding a charge. The page needs to make that distinction explicit.
- 03 **Theo:** Then a workspace with eleven editors and nine viewers has twenty members but only eleven seats counted for this price. Correct?
- 04 **Mina:** Yes. The ² _____ is eight editor seats. Eleven editors means three additional seats, not eleven additional charges.
- 05 **Theo:** At twelve dollars each, those three add thirty-six dollars. With the base charge, the full-month subtotal is one hundred fifty-six dollars.
- 06 **Mina:** That matches the proposal. Show the base, included seats, additional quantity, and unit price separately so customers can reproduce the total.
- 07 **Theo:** What if someone promotes a viewer halfway through the month? The full-month example does not tell me what to charge then.
- 08 **Mina:** The ³ _____ rule is still unresolved. Please mark that case as a decision needed, rather than assume a daily rate or a full-month charge.
- 09 **Theo:** We also need the event that changes the billable quantity. An invitation is not necessarily an accepted membership or an editor assignment.
- 10 **Mina:** Agreed. Bring those states to the billing review. The product and billing records must agree about which event starts or ends a charge.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 76.

- 11 **Theo:** The feature table has another issue. It says unlimited exports, while the proposed plan permits five scheduled exports a month.
- 12 **Mina:** That is an ⁴ _____ mismatch. Correct the capability table as well as the price; a consistent subtotal does not fix an inaccurate feature promise.
- 13 **Theo:** Does the five-export limit include manual downloads? The current wording could be read either way.
- 14 **Mina:** The proposal only specifies scheduled exports. We need the owner to confirm manual-download behavior before we publish a broader statement.
- 15 **Theo:** Some existing customers have a different plan. Should the new page imply their terms change on launch day?
- 16 **Mina:** No. ⁵ _____ is a separate policy question. Neither continued old terms nor automatic migration has been approved for those customers.
- 17 **Theo:** I will keep the existing-customer decision separate and prepare a clearly labeled example for the proposed new plan.
- 18 **Mina:** Use an ⁶ _____ with the eleven editors and nine viewers. Label it as a full-month subtotal before tax, not an actual invoice.
- 19 **Theo:** I will also list partial-month changes, invitation states, manual downloads, and existing-customer treatment as open decisions.
- 20 **Mina:** Good. We can review the example now, but the page and billing rules need the same approved definitions before launch.

09

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. seat type | 2. included allowance | 3. proration | 4. entitlement | 5. Grandfathering | 6. invoice preview

Members are mistaken for extra seats

F Say it in a new situation

Use the proposed full-month plan above. A workspace has ten editors and six viewers. No partial-month rule has been approved.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

twenty-four / two / one hundred forty-four / proration

09

Billing: Ten editors use eight included seats and ¹ _____ additional seats.

Product: That adds ² _____ dollars to the base charge.

Billing: The subtotal before tax is ³ _____ dollars.

Product: Do not apply this full-month example to an unresolved ⁴ _____ rule.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 101

1. two | 2. twenty-four | 3. one hundred forty-four | 4. proration

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

The button works, but keyboard users cannot see it

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Describe an accessibility defect precisely and negotiate a testable correction.

A new sticky promotion banner completely covers the Save button when that button receives keyboard focus. The issue is reproduced at a documented browser size and zoom setting. A mouse-only test passed. The team must define the defect and a retest, not certify the entire product.

PEOPLE / Ravi: Product owner | Ellis: Accessibility specialist

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

10

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reproduction steps / sticky banner / regression test / focus indicator / acceptance criterion / keyboard navigation

- 01 **Ravi:** The Save button passed the click test yesterday. Is this a separate defect, or the same one reported twice?
- 02 **Ellis:** It is a ¹ _____ problem. Tab reaches Save, but the promotion banner covers the entire button, so the user cannot see which control is active.
- 03 **Ravi:** Does the focus actually move to the button, or does it get trapped somewhere earlier in the page?
- 04 **Ellis:** Focus reaches it. The ² _____ is hidden along with the button. I can reproduce it using the recorded browser size and zoom.
- 05 **Ravi:** Then calling the button disabled would be inaccurate. It is active, but covered. Can you attach the sequence rather than only a screenshot?
- 06 **Ellis:** Yes. I will record the starting position, keys pressed, viewport, zoom, and expected result. The screenshot will show where the obstruction occurs.
- 07 **Ravi:** The designer asks whether making the button a brighter color would solve it. That would be a small change.
- 08 **Ellis:** Not while the ³ _____ covers it completely. We need the layout or scrolling behavior to expose the focused control, not just recolor what is behind it.
- 09 **Ravi:** Could we remove the banner from this version while the permanent change is designed? The promotional content is not essential to saving.
- 10 **Ellis:** That is an option to evaluate. Removing it still needs testing so we do not assume the replacement layout has no other problem.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 79.

- 11 **Ravi:** How should we describe the relevant accessibility requirement without claiming that one check proves the whole application conforms?
- 12 **Ellis:** Keep the ⁴ _____ specific: the focused Save control must not be entirely hidden by our content on the documented route. We should aim for it to be fully visible.
- 13 **Ravi:** And test more than that one screenshot size? The banner changes height when its text wraps.
- 14 **Ellis:** Yes. Agree relevant layouts and settings for the retest. The original reproduction is the starting point, not the entire coverage plan.
- 15 **Ravi:** We already have an automated report with no failures. Can that close this ticket?
- 16 **Ellis:** No. These ⁵ _____ still produce the problem. Automated checks are useful, but they do not replace the interaction check that exposed it.
- 17 **Ravi:** I will keep the ticket open, attach the evidence, and ask Design and Engineering to assess removing or repositioning the banner.
- 18 **Ellis:** Once the change is ready, include a ⁶ _____ for this keyboard route. Also check that Save remains operable, not merely visible.
- 19 **Ravi:** The release note can say this particular obstruction was corrected after verification, not that every accessibility issue is fixed.
- 20 **Ellis:** Exactly. Report the tested behavior and scope. That is more useful than a broad assurance unsupported by the work.

10

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. keyboard navigation | 2. focus indicator | 3. sticky banner | 4. acceptance criterion | 5. reproduction steps | 6. regression test

A clean scan is offered instead of a keyboard retest

F Say it in a new situation

After a banner change, the automated scan is clear. Nobody has repeated the keyboard route that originally hid Save.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

operable / conformance / zoom / retest

10

Product: The scan does not replace the keyboard ¹ _____.

Specialist: Repeat the recorded steps at the stated size and ² _____.

Product: Confirm that Save is visible and remains ³ _____.

Specialist: Report this correction without claiming complete ⁴ _____.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 102

1. retest | 2. zoom | 3. operable | 4. conformance

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

A research task that accidentally gives away the answer

E More workplace conversations / 1-10

Revise leading research language and agree a neutral, respectful session.

A team will observe invoice approvers using a prototype. Its draft task names the button participants are meant to discover. Recruiting has selected daily administrators, although the target role approves invoices only monthly. All invoice data will be fictional.

PEOPLE / June: Product manager | Omar: User researcher

Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Answers follow turn 20.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

recruitment screener / informed consent / usability task / discussion guide / moderator assistance / leading instruction

11

- 01 **June:** The task says, "Click the Approvals tab and approve the invoice." Is that clear enough for tomorrow's sessions?
- 02 **Omar:** It gives away the route. For a ¹ _____, describe the goal: an invoice needs your approval before payment. Let the participant find how to do it.
- 03 **June:** So we should remove the tab name. We want to observe whether they find it, not whether they can follow our instructions.
- 04 **Omar:** Exactly. That wording is a ² _____. A successful click after we name the control would not answer the original discoverability question.
- 05 **June:** The recruiting list is all administrators. They process invoices every day. Are they close enough to the monthly approvers we described?
- 06 **Omar:** Not for that question. Familiar administrators may know paths that occasional approvers have to rediscover. We need people with the relevant role and frequency of use.
- 07 **June:** Could we still interview the administrators about setup, then keep those findings separate from the approval task?
- 08 **Omar:** Possibly, but revise the ³ _____ for the approval sessions. Do not silently relabel the recruited group as representative of monthly approvers.
- 09 **June:** I will make the role and frequency explicit. What happens if a participant gets stuck and asks which tab to use?
- 10 **Omar:** Give them time and use a neutral prompt such as, "What would you do next?" If we provide help, record when and what we supplied.

The conversation, continued

E More workplace conversations / 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 82.

- 11 **June:** The observer sheet has only pass or fail. That would hide the fact that someone finished after we told them the route.
- 12 **Omar:** Add ⁴ _____ to the observation record. Completion after a hint is different from completion without help.
- 13 **June:** Sales wants to sit in and explain why we designed the screen that way. I suspect that could change what we observe.
- 14 **Omar:** Ask observers to hold comments. We are examining the interface, not testing the participant, and defending the design can discourage candid reactions.
- 15 **June:** Can we record the sessions for the team? I have not put recording in the participant information yet.
- 16 **Omar:** Arrange ⁵ _____ before recording, under our research process. Explain the purpose, access, retention, and choices clearly; do not assume attendance authorizes a recording.
- 17 **June:** We will use the fictional invoices and the prototype account. There is no need for participants to show their real invoices or passwords.
- 18 **Omar:** Good. The ⁶ _____ should also say what to do if real information appears, so the session stays within our agreed safeguards.
- 19 **June:** I will update the task, recruitment request, observer instructions, and recording information before confirming the sessions.
- 20 **Omar:** Then we can learn how the intended users approach the task, while keeping assistance and the limits of the sample visible in the findings.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. usability task | 2. leading instruction | 3. recruitment screener | 4. moderator assistance | 5. informed consent | 6. discussion guide

A prompted completion is reported as independent

F Say it in a new situation

A participant finds Approvals only after the moderator names the tab. The observer records an unassisted success.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

observation / prompt / discoverability / tab

Researcher: The participant finished after a ¹ _____.

Product: Change the result to assisted completion and retain the ² _____.

Researcher: The next task should describe the goal without naming the ³ _____.

Product: Do not use this outcome as proof of independent ⁴ _____.

11

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 103

1. prompt | 2. observation | 3. tab | 4. discoverability

Read, switch, repeat

1. Check the four answers and read the complete exchange aloud.
2. Switch roles. Read it again with the word bank covered.
3. Return to the extended conversation. Read turns 1-10, then switch roles for turns 11-20. Use the corrected expressions.

SOLO PRACTICE

Read both roles. Pause briefly at each change of speaker. Repeat any line that needed an answer check.

01 Briefing and language checks

Product Discovery and Problem Framing

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What do eight tickets describe?

B. Difficulty finding the existing Export action

Eight records concern discoverability, while four describe permission restrictions.

2. What do the other four describe?

A. The action was found, but the required permission was missing.

Those four users reached the action but could not use it under their permissions.

3. What have Morgan and Li agreed to do?

B. Prepare a two-day investigation of navigation and permission messaging.

The agreement is a bounded investigation before selecting or approving a design change.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which problem framing fits the tickets?

D. Users encounter two barriers: finding Export and understanding or obtaining the required permission.

The evidence separates discoverability and permission without assuming one implementation solves both.

2. Which statement overclaims the ticket evidence?

C. Every user is unable to export.

The reviewed tickets do not establish the experience or prevalence of the entire user population.

3. Which discovery task is appropriately focused?

D. Observe the export path and review permission messaging for the two ticket groups.

The task addresses the two identified barriers and can inform a bounded solution decision.

4. Why is adding a button not a complete answer for the four permission cases?

A. Finding an action and being authorized to use it are separate conditions.

Those users already located Export, so another location would not itself grant the missing permission.

01 Conversation answers

Product Discovery and Problem Framing

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. solution request.** Turn 2. The solution request names a new button, while the underlying evidence may support more than one kind of problem.
- 2. discoverability.** Turn 4. Discoverability concerns finding the available action, which is the barrier described in eight of the twelve tickets.
- 3. permission.** Turn 6. Permission is authorization to use the action, distinct from being able to locate it.
- 4. support evidence.** Turn 8. Support evidence provides concrete reported experiences, but the ticket sample does not establish prevalence among all users.
- 5. navigation path.** Turn 10. The navigation path records the sequence users followed and can reveal where they missed the existing action.
- 6. discovery scope.** Turn 12. Discovery scope bounds the work to navigation and permission messaging, creating a specific decision point before design selection.
- 7. research question.** Turn 14. The research question tests the user's task and obstacle instead of soliciting approval of a predetermined button solution.
- 8. user need.** Turn 16. The user need concerns accomplishing the export task appropriately, rather than mandating a specific interface element.
- 9. prototype.** Turn 18. A prototype can test a proposed design before committing to full implementation, using the findings from the bounded investigation.
- 10. problem statement.** Turn 20. The problem statement separates the two observed barriers and gives the next design discussion an evidence-based starting point.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. discoverability

Support: "Six tickets concern discoverability."

Those users could not find the existing action, which is a discoverability problem.

2. permission

Product: "Four concern permission."

The other users found Download but lacked authorization to use it.

3. approved

Support: "A design change is not yet approved."

The briefing explicitly leaves design approval absent at this stage.

4. users

Product: "These records are a ticket sample, not all users."

The supplied records do not establish the experience of every user.

02 Briefing and language checks

Roadmaps and Prioritization

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. Which feature addresses the recorded fixed commitment?

C. B, audit export

The briefing identifies B as required for the October 31 customer commitment.

2. Which pair follows the agreed priority rule?

B. B and A

B protects the fixed commitment, and A then supports the agreed activation goal.

3. What does the two-week date mean for C?

D. A review point, not a promised delivery date

Nora proposes reviewing C again in two weeks, not delivering or approving it then.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which response best explains deferring C?

B. B protects the fixed commitment and A supports activation; C does not fit the two-slot capacity.

The explanation applies the supplied rule and states the capacity consequence without personal dismissal or an invented date.

2. If C is added with no capacity change, what must happen?

B. A or B must be displaced.

Each feature requires one slot and the briefing rules out splitting, so another selection must change.

3. What new information could justify reconsideration?

A. Relevant evidence changing C's position under the agreed criteria

A priority decision can change with relevant evidence, not merely repeated preference.

4. Which statement about the review is accurate?

C. C will be reconsidered in two weeks without a promised delivery date.

A reconsideration checkpoint preserves flexibility without creating an unsupported release commitment.

02 Conversation answers

Roadmaps and Prioritization

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. capacity constraint.** Turn 2. The capacity constraint is two available delivery slots for three one-slot features, with no feasible split this cycle.
- 2. decision rule.** Turn 4. The decision rule protects recorded fixed commitments first and then the activation goal, rather than ranking sponsors by forcefulness.
- 3. fixed commitment.** Turn 6. The fixed commitment is the recorded October 31 audit-export obligation that the supplied rule prioritizes.
- 4. product goal.** Turn 8. The product goal is the agreed activation outcome, which setup recovery directly supports in the supplied facts.
- 5. scope split.** Turn 10. A scope split would divide work into useful smaller parts, but the briefing states it is not feasible this cycle.
- 6. opportunity cost.** Turn 12. Opportunity cost makes the displaced alternative visible when C competes for one of the two available slots.
- 7. review trigger.** Turn 14. A review trigger identifies new evidence or a condition that would justify reconsidering C under the agreed decision rule.
- 8. deferred item.** Turn 16. A deferred item is outside the current cycle; its review date does not guarantee a future delivery slot.
- 9. decision log.** Turn 18. The decision log preserves the selected pair, shared rationale, capacity constraint, and conditions for reconsideration.
- 10. product roadmap.** Turn 20. The product roadmap communicates the selected direction and priorities without implying that every requested feature is simultaneously committed.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. X

Product: "The first selection is X."

X protects the fixed commitment, which the stated rule ranks first.

2. Y

Sponsor: "The second selection is Y."

Y supports activation, the next criterion after fixed commitments.

3. Z

Product: "The deferred item is Z."

Z has neither supplied priority basis and cannot fit alongside both selected items.

4. trade-off

Sponsor: "Adding it requires a trade-off."

With unchanged two-slot capacity, adding Z displaces one of the selected features.

03 Briefing and language checks

User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. When does the stated timing end?

D. When records and the primary action are usable

The criterion ends at usable content and action, not merely the start of technical activity.

2. Does the trial meet the stated timing and error criterion?

D. Yes; 96 finish within 2 seconds and all finish within 5 seconds without errors.

The supplied rule requires at least 95 fast runs and all runs within the five-second ceiling, with no errors.

3. What remains open after this trial?

B. Other completion checks

Passing this criterion does not complete the other checks explicitly left open in the briefing.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which criterion matches the agreed performance rule?

A. At least 95 of 100 defined navigations usable within 2 seconds, all within 5, without errors

The correct criterion preserves usable completion, both count and ceiling requirements, and the no-error condition. An average or a loading shell measures something different.

2. What if only 94 runs meet 2 seconds, while all finish before 5 seconds without errors?

A. The stated criterion fails.

The rule independently requires at least 95 runs within two seconds, so meeting the ceiling alone is insufficient.

3. Why time until the primary action is usable?

A. The user must be able to perform the intended task, not merely see a loading shell.

The defined endpoint connects performance evidence to usable behavior instead of an earlier technical event.

4. What can Eva say after the actual trial?

C. This criterion passed under profile N; other completion checks remain open.

The evidence supports the stated test result, not untested conditions or all remaining work.

03 Conversation answers

User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. acceptance criterion. Turn 2. An acceptance criterion turns the vague performance request into a specific condition that can be evaluated.

2. usable state. Turn 4. The usable state requires the records and primary action to be available, avoiding an earlier but misleading loading milestone.

3. test fixture. Turn 6. The test fixture supplies controlled data and setup, here the fixed one-thousand-record dataset.

4. response-time threshold. Turn 8. The response-time threshold defines an acceptable duration; the case also sets a separate ceiling for every run.

5. Tail latency. Turn 10. Tail latency concerns the slower responses that can be hidden by an average and are bounded here by the five-second ceiling.

6. acceptance test. Turn 12. The acceptance test passes because the recorded run counts, ceiling, and no-error condition all satisfy the agreed rule.

7. test profile. Turn 14. The test profile identifies the environment and conditions under which the passing result was obtained.

8. Definition of Done. Turn 16. The Definition of Done is the wider agreed quality standard in Scrum, not a substitute label for one story-specific passing criterion.

9. happy path. Turn 18. The happy path is the intended successful sequence; covering it does not automatically address all exceptional or empty states.

10. completion evidence. Turn 20. Completion evidence records what has actually passed and what remains outstanding, supporting an accurate completion decision.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. 93

Tester: "The fast-run count is 93."

The result records ninety-three runs within the two-second threshold.

2. 95

Product: "The required fast-run count is at least 95."

The acceptance rule requires at least ninety-five runs within two seconds.

3. fails

Tester: "The overall criterion fails."

The fast-run requirement is missed even though the five-second ceiling and error condition are met.

4. seconds

Product: "The recorded timing unit is seconds."

All thresholds and observed durations in the briefing are expressed in seconds.

04 Briefing and language checks

Metrics, Funnels, and Product Analytics

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. How did signup count change?

A. It rose from 1,000 to 1,500, a 50% increase.

Five hundred additional signups divided by the original thousand gives a fifty-percent increase.

2. How did completed setup count change?

D. It fell from 600 to 500.

The supplied completion counts show one hundred fewer completed setups in the later cohort.

3. What makes the time windows comparable here?

B. Both cohorts have completed the same seven-day observation window.

The briefing explicitly says both cohorts are fully matured under the same seven-day definition.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which summary represents both movements?

D. Signups increased, while completed setups and the setup-completion rate declined.

The supplied counts show acquisition growth together with fewer completions and a lower rate.

2. What is the later setup-completion rate?

A. Approximately 33.33%

Five hundred completions divided by fifteen hundred signups equals one third.

3. What is the approximate rate decline in percentage points?

D. 26.67

The earlier sixty-percent rate minus approximately thirty-three point three three percent is about 26.67 points.

4. Which causal statement is supported?

C. The campaign's causal effect is not isolated by this comparison.

Verified observations do not remove the uncontrolled differences between the two periods.

04 Conversation answers

Metrics, Funnels, and Product Analytics

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. funnel. Turn 2. The funnel includes the later setup outcome as well as signup, so acquisition alone cannot represent the whole result.

2. mature cohort. Turn 4. A mature cohort has completed the defined observation period; both groups here have a full seven-day window.

3. denominator. Turn 6. The denominator is each cohort's eligible signup count, which must remain aligned with its own completions.

4. conversion rate. Turn 8. The conversion rate is the share of signups completing setup within seven days, not the raw completion count.

5. setup completion. Turn 10. Setup completion is the defined downstream event whose count and rate both declined in the supplied comparison.

6. channel mix. Turn 12. Channel mix concerns the composition of acquisition sources and is a possible explanation to investigate, not an established cause here.

7. drop-off. Turn 14. Drop-off identifies loss between defined funnel steps; step-level evidence is needed to locate the obstacle.

8. instrumentation. Turn 16. Instrumentation produces the event records; verifying those counts does not establish the causal explanation for their movement.

9. segmentation. Turn 18. Segmentation separates relevant groups for analysis while preserving the defined outcome and comparison basis.

10. attribution. Turn 20. Attribution assigns credit under a stated method; the uncontrolled cohort comparison does not isolate the campaign's causal contribution.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. 50

Analyst: "The earlier completion rate was 50 percent."

One hundred completions divided by two hundred signups equals fifty percent.

2. 20

Growth: "The later rate was 20 percent."

Eighty completions divided by four hundred signups equals twenty percent.

3. 30

Analyst: "The rate declined by 30 percentage points."

Fifty percent minus twenty percent equals thirty percentage points.

4. unestablished

Growth: "The cause remains unestablished."

The briefing supplies descriptive cohort results but no established causal explanation.

05 Briefing and language checks

Experimentation and A/B Testing

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What are the observed conversion rates?

C. A is 10% and B is 12%.

One hundred and one hundred twenty conversions divided by one thousand users give ten and twelve percent.

2. Which final-analysis prerequisites remain unmet?

A. Fourteen days and at least 10,000 users per arm

The case is on day one with one thousand users per arm, below both planned prerequisites.

3. Does B currently exceed the specified error guardrail?

A. No; 1.2% is below 3%.

The current error rate is below the stated threshold, which still remains active during the test.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which update is justified?

C. B leads descriptively on day one; the planned final-analysis requirements are unmet.

The update preserves the observed lead without converting interim counts into a final decision.

2. What is the relative increase from 10% to 12%?

D. 20%

The two-point increase divided by the ten-percent control rate equals twenty percent.

3. What should happen if the defined guardrail is later exceeded?

A. Follow the pre-agreed pause and investigation rule.

The guardrail protects against unacceptable effects throughout the test and is distinct from the success analysis.

4. Why not stop for success simply because B leads today?

D. The fixed-horizon plan has no approved early-success method.

The correct decision follows the approved method; interim monitoring does not authorize opportunistic success stopping.

05 Conversation answers

Experimentation and A/B Testing

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

1. interim result. Turn 2. An interim result is observed before the planned endpoint; these day-one counts do not establish the final experiment decision.

2. control arm. Turn 4. The control arm is A, whose ten-percent rate provides the reference for the stated relative increase.

3. fixed-horizon test. Turn 6. A fixed-horizon test follows its preplanned endpoint and analysis rules rather than stopping whenever an interim result looks favorable.

4. stopping rule. Turn 8. The stopping rule determines when a decision is permitted; changing it after repeated favorable looks can invalidate the planned inference.

5. guardrail. Turn 10. The guardrail protects against unacceptable effects during the experiment and remains active before the final success analysis.

6. Sequential testing. Turn 12. Sequential testing is a method designed for valid repeated decisions; none is approved here for declaring early success.

7. sample ratio mismatch. Turn 14. A sample ratio mismatch can indicate a problem in allocation or data capture, so it must be assessed rather than ignored for a favorable outcome.

8. novelty effect. Turn 16. A novelty effect is a temporary response to the new experience and is one possible reason early behavior may not persist.

9. practical significance. Turn 18. Practical significance concerns whether the effect matters operationally and is distinct from the statistical evidence for a difference.

10. minimum sample. Turn 20. The minimum sample is ten thousand eligible users per arm, an unmet prerequisite that cannot be silently lowered after favorable results.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. 8

Analyst: "A converts 8 percent."

Forty conversions divided by five hundred users equals eight percent.

2. 10

Product: "B converts 10 percent."

Fifty conversions divided by five hundred users equals ten percent.

3. 25

Analyst: "The relative increase is 25 percent."

The two-point increase divided by the eight-percent control rate equals twenty-five percent.

4. undecided

Product: "The final winner remains undecided."

The approved final-analysis prerequisites are unmet and no early-success method is approved.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Release Readiness and Go-to-Market

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. Which readiness item is missing?

D. Migration notes delivered to Support and confirmed usable

The checklist requirement for Support's migration notes has not been met.

2. What does Friday 10 a.m. represent?

B. The planned launch review

The briefing identifies a review meeting, not a recorded authorization to launch.

3. What can Ana do now?

A. Assign note delivery and request Support review.

Ana can coordinate completion of the missing requirement but cannot invent its fulfillment or launch approval.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which readiness statement is accurate?

B. Engineering is ready; the required Support handoff remains incomplete.

The statement recognizes completed engineering work while preserving the separate open launch condition.

2. What evidence closes the stated Support item?

C. Delivery of the notes and the Support lead's usability confirmation

The checklist explicitly requires both delivery and confirmation that the recipient can use the notes.

3. Which announcement decision fits the facts?

C. Keep the customer availability announcement pending the release decision.

No launch approval or waiver exists, so the announcement must not represent either as settled.

4. What should happen if confirmation is still missing at the review?

D. Present the unresolved gate and follow the authorized go/no-go process.

An unmet requirement must remain visible to the decision process rather than be silently bypassed.

06 Conversation answers

Release Readiness and Go-to-Market

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. launch checklist.** Turn 2. The launch checklist includes the Support migration-note requirement as well as engineering and rollback checks.
- 2. Support enablement.** Turn 4. Support enablement prepares the team to assist customers with the change and is a required part of readiness here.
- 3. dependency owner.** Turn 6. The dependency owner is responsible for producing the missing input, making the delivery request actionable.
- 4. migration notes.** Turn 8. Migration notes explain how to move to or handle the changed behavior, and must actually reach Support in usable form.
- 5. acceptance confirmation.** Turn 10. Acceptance confirmation records that Support considers the delivered notes usable, not merely that an attachment was transmitted.
- 6. go/no-go decision.** Turn 12. The go/no-go decision is the pending authorization point, distinct from scheduling the meeting or completing engineering work.
- 7. customer announcement.** Turn 14. The customer announcement must reflect actual availability and approval, so it should not get ahead of the pending release decision.
- 8. contingency.** Turn 16. The contingency states the response if the required delivery or confirmation is missing, preserving the authorized decision process.
- 9. readiness evidence.** Turn 18. Readiness evidence shows that the actual checklist condition has been met and can be reviewed by the decision owner.
- 10. operational readiness.** Turn 20. Operational readiness includes the people and processes needed to support the live change, not only the software's technical state.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. delivery

Release: "The guide reached Support, so we can record delivery."

Delivery is the recorded transfer of the guide, not acceptance of its contents.

2. confirmation

Support: "You still need my usability confirmation before closing that item."

The recipient must confirm usability; sending the document does not establish this.

3. review

Release: "We will take the open item to the launch review tomorrow."

Tomorrow is the scheduled review, not a recorded decision or completed handoff.

4. approval

Marketing: "I will keep the availability announcement unsent until we have launch approval."

Approval is still absent, so Marketing cannot announce an authorized launch yet.

07 Briefing and language checks

Platform, APIs, and Technical Debt

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. Which estimate fits inside the requested five-day window?

C. The three-day adapter estimate

Three days is within five, while ten exceeds it; feasibility and authorization still require the stated conditions.

2. What does the adapter duplicate?

B. An existing transformation

The supplied concern is duplicated transformation logic, creating a maintenance responsibility.

3. Which constraint applies to existing clients?

D. Their current behavior must be preserved.

The briefing explicitly requires existing clients to retain their current behavior.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which proposal accurately describes the adapter?

C. A three-day estimated single-client pilot with required ownership, monitoring, rollback, and expiry controls

The adapter's timing advantage comes with a narrow scope and explicit unresolved operating and retirement requirements.

2. Why does duplicated transformation logic matter?

D. Future changes may require both copies to stay consistent.

Maintaining the same transformation in two places creates a concrete consistency and ownership burden.

3. What is a compatibility question?

C. Will existing clients receive behavior they can still handle under the current contract?

Compatibility concerns consumers' actual expectations and supported behavior, not labels or assumed adoption.

4. What should happen at the 30-day limit?

B. Follow the approved expiry or explicit extension process.

The time limit requires a controlled decision or retirement, not silent continuation or an invented replacement.

07 Conversation answers

Platform, APIs, and Technical Debt

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. adapter.** Turn 2. The adapter is the narrow translation component estimated at three days, potentially serving a single-client pilot rather than the shared product.
- 2. duplicated logic.** Turn 4. Duplicated logic means maintaining the same transformation in more than one place, creating future consistency work.
- 3. Maintenance burden.** Turn 6. Maintenance burden is the ongoing effort and risk of keeping the temporary path correct, monitored, and consistent.
- 4. API contract.** Turn 8. The API contract includes the supported inputs, outputs, and behavior on which existing consumers depend.
- 5. breaking change.** Turn 10. A breaking change can invalidate existing client expectations even when the visible endpoint or field names remain similar.
- 6. blast radius.** Turn 12. Blast radius is the scope of affected consumers and systems, which the single-client pilot must explicitly bound.
- 7. ownership.** Turn 14. Ownership names responsibility for operating and maintaining the adapter after its initial implementation.
- 8. rollback plan.** Turn 16. The rollback plan defines how the pilot can be reversed if necessary, rather than assuming temporary code is automatically easy to remove.
- 9. expiry condition.** Turn 18. The expiry condition makes the thirty-day limit actionable through retirement or an explicit authorized extension.
- 10. retirement plan.** Turn 20. The retirement plan specifies how the temporary path will be removed or replaced, so its future work is visible in the choice.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. 2

Product: "The adapter estimate is 2 days."

The supplied estimate for the narrow adapter is two days.

2. 8

Engineering: "The shared option needs 8 days."

The broader interface work is estimated at eight days.

3. 21

Product: "The adapter limit is 21 days unless extended."

The proposed expiry condition is twenty-one days with an explicit extension route.

4. approval

Engineering: "Both options still need approval."

The briefing states that neither proposal has been approved.

08 Briefing and language checks

Stakeholder Pushback and Executive Narrative

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is the shared quarterly objective?

A. Reduce support friction for existing paid teams

The briefing identifies support friction among existing paid teams as the agreed objective.

2. What does 40 of 100 mean?

D. Forty reviewed tickets belong to the relevant error category.

The count concerns reviewed tickets, not distinct customers, population prevalence, or retention effects.

3. Who makes the supplied decision?

C. Malik, the executive chair

The case explicitly assigns decision authority to the executive chair.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which opening is most decision-ready?

A. I recommend the two-week reliability pilot because it matches our agreed objective and documented ticket evidence.

The opening states the action, duration, objective fit, and evidence without personal attack or unsupported outcomes.

2. How should Iris describe the alternative?

A. It could support prospect conversations, but the supplied pipeline is uncommitted.

A fair comparison recognizes possible value while preserving the actual commitment status.

3. What does approval of the requested pilot authorize?

B. The defined two-week pilot within its agreed scope

The request is explicitly bounded to one pilot and does not authorize unrelated work or establish outcomes.

4. Which statement about the ticket evidence is accurate?

B. It identifies a documented issue category but does not establish distinct-customer count or retention impact.

The supplied unit is reviewed tickets, and the broader customer and causal claims are expressly unestablished.

08 Conversation answers

Stakeholder Pushback and Executive Narrative

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

1. recommendation. Turn 2. The recommendation is a specific proposed action, the two-week reliability pilot, rather than a claim that approval already exists.

2. shared objective. Turn 4. The shared objective is reducing support friction for existing paid teams, providing the common basis for this decision.

3. ticket category. Turn 6. A ticket category groups support records; forty tickets in it do not establish forty distinct customers.

4. retention effect. Turn 8. A retention effect would require evidence about continued use and attribution, neither of which is established by the ticket count.

5. uncommitted pipeline. Turn 10. Uncommitted pipeline represents potential business without the relevant confirmed commitment, limiting the strength of the dashboard's current case.

6. displaced work. Turn 12. Displaced work is the sales-dashboard pilot that cannot proceed alongside A under the one-pilot capacity limit.

7. decision boundary. Turn 14. The decision boundary limits the requested authorization to the defined two-week pilot, not an unrestricted rollout.

8. success measure. Turn 16. The success measure defines how the pilot will be evaluated before results are interpreted, avoiding a retrospective change of criteria.

9. follow-up review. Turn 18. The follow-up review evaluates the pilot evidence after two weeks without guaranteeing a positive result in advance.

10. decision record. Turn 20. The decision record captures the authorized choice, scope, rationale, and conditions so teams do not infer more than was decided.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. 25

Product: "The error appears in 25 percent of reviewed tickets."

Twenty tickets divided by eighty reviewed tickets equals twenty-five percent.

2. tickets

Chair: "The unit counted is tickets."

The evidence counts support records, not distinct customers or retained accounts.

3. 10

Product: "The proposed pilot lasts 10 days."

The briefing defines the recommended pilot duration as ten days.

4. approval

Chair: "The recommendation still requires my approval."

The product lead recommends the pilot, while final approval belongs to the chair.

08

09 Conversation answers

What exactly counts as a paid seat?

E Extended conversation

Pages 76-77

1. seat type. Turn 2. Seat type distinguishes editors, who count toward this proposed price, from viewers, who do not.

2. included allowance. Turn 4. The included allowance covers eight editor seats within the base price; only the additional three incur the stated extra charge.

3. proration. Turn 8. Proration concerns adjusting a charge for part of a billing period; the full-month example supplies no approved partial-month rule.

4. entitlement. Turn 12. An entitlement is a capability or allowance provided by the plan, distinct from the number of seats used to calculate its price.

5. Grandfathering. Turn 16. Grandfathering means retaining specified existing terms for an eligible group; whether it applies here remains a separate unapproved policy decision.

6. invoice preview. Turn 18. An invoice preview shows the proposed charge breakdown before final billing; it is not evidence that an unlaunched plan or unresolved policy is approved.

F Transfer exchange

Page 78

1. two

Billing: Ten editors use eight included seats and two additional seats.

Ten minus the eight included editor seats leaves two separately charged seats.

2. twenty-four

Product: That adds twenty-four dollars to the base charge.

Two additional editor seats multiplied by twelve dollars gives twenty-four dollars.

3. one hundred forty-four

Billing: The subtotal before tax is one hundred forty-four dollars.

The one-hundred-twenty-dollar base plus twenty-four dollars gives the stated subtotal.

4. proration

Product: Do not apply this full-month example to an unresolved proration rule.

The example contains no approved method for charging part of a month.

10 Conversation answers

The button works, but keyboard users cannot see it

E Extended conversation

Pages 79-80

- 1. keyboard navigation.** Turn 2. Keyboard navigation uses keys to move between and operate controls; a successful mouse click does not establish that this route is usable.
- 2. focus indicator.** Turn 4. The focus indicator is the visible cue identifying the active control; here both it and the button are hidden behind the banner.
- 3. sticky banner.** Turn 8. The sticky banner remains positioned over the focused control; changing the color of a completely covered button would not remove that obstruction.
- 4. acceptance criterion.** Turn 12. The acceptance criterion defines the specific observable result required for this correction; passing it does not establish complete accessibility conformance.
- 5. reproduction steps.** Turn 16. Reproduction steps describe how to observe the actual defect; a clean automated report does not disprove a manually reproducible keyboard problem.
- 6. regression test.** Turn 18. A regression test checks that a previously identified problem stays corrected and that the change has not reintroduced the relevant failure.

F Transfer exchange

Page 81

- 1. retest**

Product: The scan does not replace the keyboard retest.

The original interaction must be checked again; an automated result alone does not establish the correction.
- 2. zoom**

Specialist: Repeat the recorded steps at the stated size and zoom.

The reproduction includes the zoom setting, which can change the layout and obstruction.
- 3. operable**

Product: Confirm that Save is visible and remains operable.

A visible control must still work; appearance alone does not establish usable interaction.
- 4. conformance**

Specialist: Report this correction without claiming complete conformance.

One corrected defect does not prove that the entire product meets all accessibility requirements.

10

Background reading: **W3C: Focus Not Obscured (Minimum)**. The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

11 Conversation answers

A research task that accidentally gives away the answer

E Extended conversation

Pages 82-83

- 1. usability task.** Turn 2. A usability task sets a goal for the participant without supplying the interface actions whose discoverability the research is intended to examine.
- 2. leading instruction.** Turn 4. A leading instruction directs the participant toward a particular action and can obscure whether the interface itself supports the task.
- 3. recruitment screener.** Turn 8. The recruitment screener checks participant characteristics against the research question; role and frequency matter more here than general familiarity with the product.
- 4. moderator assistance.** Turn 12. Moderator assistance is help supplied during the session; documenting it distinguishes independent task completion from completion after prompting or guidance.
- 5. informed consent.** Turn 16. Informed consent requires participants to understand and agree to the proposed research and recording arrangements; attendance alone does not establish agreement to recording.
- 6. discussion guide.** Turn 18. The discussion guide provides the planned tasks and neutral prompts, helping sessions address the same questions without prescribing participants' actions.

F Transfer exchange

Page 84

1. prompt

Researcher: The participant finished after a prompt.

Naming the tab supplied guidance before completion, so the recorded outcome was not independent.

2. observation

Product: Change the result to assisted completion and retain the observation.

The record should preserve what happened rather than erase the session or pretend it was unassisted.

3. tab

Researcher: The next task should describe the goal without naming the tab.

Naming the interface location gives away the route the task is meant to investigate.

4. discoverability

Product: Do not use this outcome as proof of independent discoverability.

Completion after supplied navigation does not establish that users can find the control themselves.

11

Background reading: [GOV.UK: Using Moderated Usability Testing](#). The conversation is an original fictional teaching case.

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Product Discovery and Problem Framing

Acknowledge the problem: We should address the export friction in these tickets.

Split the evidence: Eight tickets concern finding the action; four concern permission.

Limit the inference: These tickets do not establish prevalence across all users.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Roadmaps and Prioritization

State the capacity: We have two slots for three one-slot features.

Connect the outcome: A directly supports setup recovery and activation.

Ask what gives way: Which selected item would C displace?

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 User Stories and Acceptance Criteria

Clarify the user state: The story concerns an authorized editor.

Define the finish: Stop when the records and primary action are usable.

Bound the slow runs: Every run must finish within 5 seconds.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Metrics, Funnels, and Product Analytics

Acknowledge acquisition: Signups increased from 1,000 to 1,500.

Give the later rate: The later completion rate was approximately 33.33%.

Confirm definitions: The setup-completion definition is unchanged.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Experimentation and A/B Testing

Give the counts: A has 100 conversions and B has 120, each from 1,000 users.

Qualify maturity: This is a day-one result.

Avoid opportunistic stopping: We have no approved early-success rule.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Release Readiness and Go-to-Market

Acknowledge completed work: Engineering checks are complete and rollback was rehearsed.

Separate team readiness: Code readiness is not the whole launch checklist.

Keep the review: Friday's go/no-go review can remain scheduled.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Platform, APIs, and Technical Debt

Set out the options: The adapter is estimated at three days; the shared API work at ten.

Expose the duplication: It repeats an existing transformation.

Limit exposure: Keep the pilot's blast radius explicit.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Stakeholder Pushback and Executive Narrative

Lead with the action: I recommend the two-week reliability pilot.

Protect the unit: Those are tickets, not 40 distinct customers.

State the trade-off: Choosing A defers the sales-dashboard pilot.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

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acceptance confirmation obtain acceptance confirmation	51
acceptance criterion define acceptance criteria	23
acceptance test run the acceptance test	24
access barrier identify the access barrier	5
activation define activation	32
adapter scope the adapter	59
ambiguity remove ambiguity	24
API define the API contract	59
API contract preserve the API contract	59
assumption test the assumption	6
assumption check conduct an assumption check	69
attribution qualify campaign attribution	33
backlog ordering revise backlog ordering	15
backward compatibility maintain backward compatibility	59
blast radius limit the blast radius	60
breaking change identify a breaking change	59
capacity constraint state the capacity constraint	14
channel mix examine channel mix	33
client-specific logic isolate client-specific logic	60
cohort compare signup cohorts	32
cohort maturity check cohort maturity	33
completion evidence attach completion evidence	24
confidence interval report a confidence interval	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

confidence level qualify the confidence level	15
contingency agree the contingency	51
control arm define the control arm	41
conversion rate calculate conversion rate	32
cost of delay assess cost of delay	15
counterargument address the counterargument	69
customer announcement approve the customer announcement	51
customer friction reduce customer friction	68
day-of-week effect examine day-of-week effects	42
decision boundary state the decision boundary	69
decision criterion agree the decision criterion	68
decision log maintain the decision log	15
decision owner identify the decision owner	69
decision record preserve the decision record	69
decision request state the decision request	68
decision rule use the decision rule	15
deduplication apply deduplication	33
deferred item record a deferred item	14
Definition of Done meet the Definition of Done	23
delivery slot allocate a delivery slot	14
denominator verify the denominator	33
dependency identify a dependency	14
dependency owner name the dependency owner	51
deprecation communicate deprecation	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

desirability assess desirability	6
discoverability improve discoverability	5
discovery scope bound the discovery scope	6
displaced work name the displaced work	69
distinct customer count distinct customers	68
drop-off locate funnel drop-off	33
duplicated logic track duplicated logic	60
edge case cover edge cases	24
effort estimate review the effort estimate	15
eligibility rule apply eligibility rules	41
empty state design the empty state	24
endpoint document the endpoint	59
error state handle the error state	24
escalation define the escalation route	15
escalation path confirm the escalation path	51
event definition maintain event definitions	32
event property validate event properties	32
evidence gap identify the evidence gap	6
evidence strength qualify evidence strength	68
executive narrative shape the executive narrative	68
expiry condition set the expiry condition	60
exposure event validate the exposure event	41
extension decision require an extension decision	60
false positive control false-positive risk	42

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

feasibility assess feasibility	6
feature flag configure a feature flag	50
fixed commitment protect a fixed commitment	14
fixed-horizon test follow the fixed-horizon plan	41
follow-up review schedule the follow-up review	69
forecast distinguish forecast from commitment	15
friction point locate a friction point	5
functional requirement specify a functional requirement	23
funnel analyze the funnel	32
go-to-market align the go-to-market plan	50
go/no-go decision record the go/no-go decision	50
guardrail monitor the guardrail	41
guardrail metric monitor guardrail metrics	33
happy path test the happy path	24
hypothesis state the hypothesis	6
instrumentation verify instrumentation	32
interim result qualify interim results	42
job to be done clarify the job to be done	5
known issue disclose known issues	50
lagging indicator report a lagging indicator	33
latency measure latency	23
launch checklist complete the launch checklist	50
launch gate satisfy the launch gate	51
launch hold communicate a launch hold	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

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mature cohort use mature cohorts	32
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migration notes deliver migration notes	50
migration path provide a migration path	59
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Find a term and its context

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platform capability	invest in platform capability	59
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Find a term and its context

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Find a term and its context

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workaround document the workaround	50

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] Government Digital Service. Learning About Users and Their Needs.

[Open the original source](#)

Background on distinguishing user needs from proposed solutions and connecting needs to user stories. The cases are original software-product examples. Checked 30 September 2026.

[2] Schwaber, K., and Sutherland, J. The Scrum Guide, November 2020.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for Scrum-specific terms such as Product Goal, Product Backlog, and Definition of Done. The book does not assume every organization uses Scrum. Checked 30 September 2026.

[3] Microsoft Research. Patterns of Trustworthy Experimentation: During-Experiment Stage.

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[4] Google. API Improvement Proposal 180: Backwards Compatibility.

[Open the original source](#)

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Phil Stilwell

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